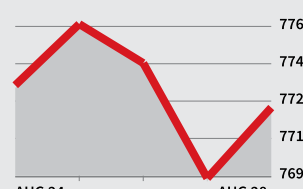


the hindu businessline

SENSEX 77264.51 (+330.92)



IN FOCUS

	LATEST	CHANGE
Nifty 50	24175.65	+84.80
P/E Ratio (Sensex)	20.47	+0.09
US Dollar (in ₹)	95.37	-0.17
Gold Std 10 gm (in ₹)	158939.00	+1187
Silver 1 kg (in ₹)	243892.00	+4392

GROWTH PLAY.

Sandhya Devanathan, Meta's India and Southeast Asia head, joins OpenAI as VP for Southeast Asia and Australia **p10**



AUTO FOCUS.

Land Rover Defender Trophy Edition revives Camel Trophy spirit with striking looks **p4**

BENGALURU • CHENNAI • COIMBATORE • HUBBALLI • HYDERABAD • KOCHI • KOLKATA • MADURAI • MALAPPURAM • MANGALURU • MUMBAI • NOIDA • THIRUVANANTHAPURAM • TIRUCHIRAPPALLI • VIJAYAWADA • VISAKHAPATNAM

Regd. TN/ARD/14/2012-2014, RNI No. 55320/94

QUICKLY.

ENERGY SHIFT

Renewables generated one-fifth of power in July



New Delhi: Renewables accounted for a record 20 per cent or one-fifth of the country's cumulative power generation during July. The timing of this feat matters, considering that India's power demand surged by almost 11 per cent y-o-y last month to around 171 billion units — the highest on record for any month. For comparison, in July 2025, power demand grew a mere 2.6 per cent. **p3**

MANDATE CHANGE

Govt to issue fortnightly sugar sale quota for mills

New Delhi: The Centre on Friday announced a change in the mill-wise quota allocation system for sugar sales in the domestic market by introducing it on a fortnightly basis from September, replacing the monthly quota system. The government also stipulated that every mill will have to sell at least 40 per cent of the fortnightly allocation in the first week and the remaining in the following week. **p8**

Jio Platforms gets SEBI nod for a record ₹37,700-crore IPO

BIG FLOAT. IPO comprises fresh issue of 27 crore shares, with no offer-for-sale component

Vallari Sanzgiri
Mumbai

Reliance Industries' digital arm Jio Platforms on Friday received SEBI's nod to float India's largest-ever initial public offer of about ₹37,700 crore.

The company received the observation letter on the Draft Red Herring Prospectus filed for its proposed IPO from the market regulator, clearing the path for Jio to move ahead with its listing plans. The company reported a consolidated net profit of ₹30,064 crore on revenues of ₹1.49 lakh crore in FY26.

NO OFFER FOR SALE

As per the company's DRHP, Jio's offering comprises a fresh issue of 27 crore equity shares with a face value of ₹10 each and has no offer-for-sale component, indicating existing investors' inclination not to exit from the company during listing. The company's existing investors include companies like Google, Meta and Silver Lake. While the IPO's net proceeds will be largely used for repayment of outstand-



GROWTH SPURT. In the latest quarter, Jio's telecom arm reported robust performance, with continued subscriber additions, modest ARPU improvement and record-high EBITDA margins

ing debt, analysts remain bullish on the IPO's ability to attract investor interest.

"Jio has strong cash flows, and coming back with a listing allows them a more focused approach going ahead. They might clear debt, but as the opportunity arises, they have levers and leverage to raise equity and debt if needed," said Kranthi Bathini, Director of Equity Strategy at WealthMills Securities.

Brokerages estimate a capital raise between ₹33,000 crore and ₹38,000 crore as against the borrowings of ₹27,500 crore, leaving

the company with only ₹5,500-10,500 crore for other corporate needs. Debt repayment will also drastically bring down interest cost by ₹2,000-2,500 crore, as per Deven Choksey of DRChoksey Finserv.

MARKET IMPACT

Regarding the market impact, Choksey said, "Assuming a listing market-cap of ₹13-14 lakh crore, Jio will rank among the first 5 listed companies in the country and attract a lot of investors. Listing also raises the company's growth programme to a much bigger scale. Growing

at 20 per cent, Jio's market-cap may reach ₹20 lakh crore in 2-3 years. This is at par with Reliance Industries' current market cap."

At the same time, Shriram Subramanian, Founder of proxy advisory firm InGovern, pointed out that Jio's listing, by itself, will not lead to a holding-company discount for RIL. The parent company, though traditionally dependent on petrochemicals and oil and gas businesses, now holds a more diversified business mix, with retail and telecom making significant contributions to revenue and profit.

Jio's IPO may also bring favourable tides to India's data centre segment, wherein a few other players like Sify and ESDS Software Solutions have tried for IPOs, said Yugal Joshi, Partner at Everest Group.

In the latest quarter, Jio's telecom arm reported robust performance, with continued subscriber additions, modest ARPU improvement and record-high EBITDA margins. EBITDA grew by 15 per cent to ₹20,865 crore, with margins expanding 150 basis points.

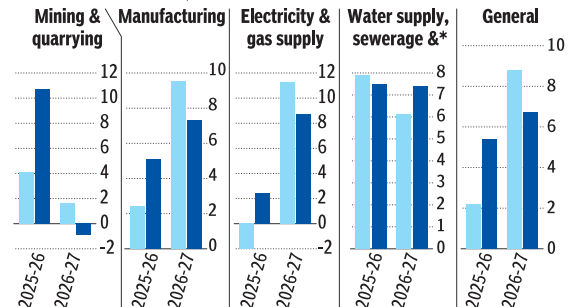
Industrial growth slowed to 6.7% in July, dragged by mining sector

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi

India's industrial output expansion eased to 6.7 per cent in July, down from 7.3 per cent in June, despite manufacturing holding firm.

Analysts suggest that overall growth could hit 8 per cent this fiscal, contingent on a strong festival season rebound.

Growth snapshot



Source: MoSPI All figures in%, Base: 2022-23=100

*waste management

MANUFACTURING LEADS According to the National Statistics Office, the July headline number was "supported by 7.3 per cent growth in the manufacturing sector and strong growth of 8.7 per cent in the electricity and gas supply sector".

The data showed that the mining and quarrying sector contracted by 0.9 per cent in July against 10.7 per cent growth a year ago.

In the manufacturing sector, 19 out of 23 industry groups recorded a positive year-on-year growth in July.

"July IIP data confirms that growth momentum in the economy remains strong," said Rajni Thakur, Chief Economist, L&T Finance.

Further, she highlighted that 16 per cent growth in capital goods production, 10 per cent growth in interme-

diate goods, and 11 per cent growth in consumer durables production reflected a broad-based strength in industrial activity in the country.

Rajeev Sharan, Head of Research, Brickwork Ratings, noted that consumer durables, the big-ticket items such as vehicles and appliances, grew 10.5 per cent, while everyday goods such as food and toiletries fell 1 per cent. The same split runs through factory output, with motor vehicles up 22.2 per cent and electrical equipment up 28.3 per cent, against 2.6 per cent for food products and a 0.6 per cent fall in clothing.

"This suggests discretionary and credit-linked purchases remain strong, while everyday items, more closely tied to rural incomes and real

wages, remain weak," he said.

GROWTH DRIVER

Growth in the coming months will depend on festival demand.

Madan Sabnavis, Chief Economist, Bank of Baroda, stated that for the four months, growth was driven by manufacturing at 7 per cent and electricity at 8.7 per cent. However, the mining sector was depressed at -1.1 per cent, which can be attributed partly to the monsoon effect. Interestingly, the rare earths category registered growth of over 20 per cent, though from a small base.

"For the year ahead, IIP growth could be in the region of 7-8 per cent," he said, "especially if the festival demand is retained this year as it was last year."

Subhash Chandra disputes 'haircut', says most of Group's debts repaid; 'plans to go to Switzerland'

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Zee Group Founder Subhash Chandra, in a video message on Friday, challenged the allegations of financial swindling against him, and aired plans to visit Switzerland in the coming weeks.

"For the past two days, I have been clubbed with people from this country who have swindled the financial system, taken the money, and bought palaces and ships for themselves. [In 2019,] I wrote an open letter to the country's banking system admitting my mistakes. I said I and the borrowing entities from my group will pay the entire system's money and we did that," said Chandra in the message in Hindi.

The media baron was speaking in the context of the the National Company



Zee Group Founder Subhash Chandra

Law Tribunal's decision to allow Chandra's repayment plan of only ₹6.5 crore against admitted claims of over ₹22,000 crore. The news had garnered strong reactions, especially from lenders such as HDFC Bank, which said it was mulling the possibility of appealing to the Appellate Tribunal.

PAID SUM & THEN SOME Chandra argued that the

company had already repaid about ₹43,000 crore of the ₹45,000 crore total outstanding, with the remaining amount pending due to complications in the asset liabilities of other companies.

"I had signed some personal guarantees to some lenders. Even some lenders whose entire money was repaid have entered their claim in the NCLT. It shouldn't have happened," said Chandra, adding that he must have paid at least ₹70,000 crore to the financial system in his working life.

Chandra on Friday also accused media channels of Mukesh Ambani of spreading inaccurate figures related to claims. He stated that he had written to Ambani regarding the same.

Later, the Reliance Group responded to the accusations "with dismay" and strongly denied the allega-

tions and insinuations against the media entities.

Speaking about the future, Chandra said he planned to meet "a friend in Switzerland" within the next two weeks for help in "investment work".

"I will see his investment in India and other places so that I can re-establish myself," he added.

He also dismissed claims of huge personal wealth as a "myth", arguing that in 2016, he had declared his personal wealth to be ₹39.70 crore.

"So, how will it become ₹45,000 crore in 2017," he asked, adding that the Finance Minister and the Banking Secretary should do an independent audit.

In a separate statement, Chandra also dismissed claims that the companies in favour of the repayment plan were associate entities.

Also read p2

CROWNING GLORY



FROM TRAILING TO TRIUMPH. Grandmaster R Praggnanandhaa became the first Indian to clinch the Grand Chess Tour Title, beating Fabiano Caruana of the US, at the GCT 2026 in St Louis, US. Praggnanandhaa made a turnaround after trailing Caruana at the start of day. He prevailed over Caruana 15-13 to win his maiden GCT Title and pocket \$2,00,000 as the winning purse **Report on p10 p11**

Cakes, flowers and pets reinvent Raksha Bandhan

How the spending basket around one of India's biggest family festivals has expanded

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

Ten-year-old Reyansh Sachdev doesn't have a sibling. So his parents, television scriptwriter Surbhi Sachdev and media research expert Rahul Sachdev, found another way for him to celebrate Raksha Bandhan: By tying a *rakhi* to Chikki, their four-year-old Shih Tzu.

The Sachdevs are part of a broader shift that retailers are now monetising. The thread remains at the centre of a festival expected to generate ₹30,000-32,000 crore of trade nationally, though bakers, florists, jewellers, pet-care brands, gifting platforms and quick-commerce companies fought for the ₹5,000-7,000 crore spent on everything that goes into the basket.

The *rakhi* itself accounts for an estimated ₹25,000 crore, according to the

Confederation of All India Traders (CAIT).

Hospitality and retail expert Sheldon Santwan sees the change as Raksha Bandhan's evolution from a largely single-product festival into a broader consumption occasion, expanding into many other categories.

FURRY THREADS

Online marketplaces and specialist pet-care brands are selling pet-friendly *rakhis*, bandanas, treats and gift boxes for dogs and cats, tapping rising spending on pets.

Santwan says that the significance lies less in the size of the category than in retailers creating a purchase occasion that had little connection with Raksha Bandhan.

Cakes, too, are entering the space, for long dominated by *mithai*. Searches for



The rakhi itself accounts for around ₹25,000 crore, per CAIT EMMANUAL YOGINI

cake shops surged 38 per cent in Chandigarh and 20 per cent in Delhi, while Bengaluru, Chennai, Hyderabad and Pune recorded increases of 9-12 per cent, according to Justdial.

Bakingo sold *rakhi* photo cakes from ₹739, Ferns N Petals paired cakes with *rakhis*, Theobroma had a ₹715 Raksha Bandhan Special eggless Dutch truffle cake, while Magnolia Bakery introduced limited-edition *rakhi* cupcakes.

Flowers are making a

similar crossover. Gifting platforms are bundling bouquets with *rakhis*, chocolates, cakes and personalised messages, bringing a product more commonly associated with Valentine's Day, birthdays and anniversaries into Raksha Bandhan.

Meanwhile, the thread itself has been premiumised. The basic ₹10 *rakhi* now shares shelves with silver, gemstone, designer and personalised versions commanding multiples of mass-market prices.

BATTLE FOR THE BASKET

Quick commerce is widening the opportunity by allowing consumers to add sweets, flowers, *rakhis* and gifts at the last minute.

Swiggy recorded a 32.4 per cent increase in festival food orders during Raksha Bandhan, while non-metro orders grew 38.1 per cent.

TVS Motor Company picks French automotive veteran Peyman Kargar as the next CEO

Sindhu Hariharan
Chennai

French automotive executive Peyman Kargar is set to become the new CEO of India's third-largest two-wheeler maker, TVS Motor Company, just 17 months after joining the company as the President of its International Division.

TVS Motor Company announced the appointment of Kargar as Director and Chief Executive Officer, effective January 27, 2027. He will succeed KN Radhakrishnan, who will continue in his role until January 2027 and then become a Non-Executive Director until the date of the ensuing AGM in July 2027.

Radhakrishnan took charge as CEO and President in 2008.

GLOBAL EXPERIENCE

With over three decades of experience across global car companies spanning Europe,

Asia, Africa and the Middle East, Kargar will help TVS Motor in its key focus areas of premiumisation, global expansion, and product innovation. His reputation as a turnaround specialist, along with a global footprint cutting across product development, R&D, manufacturing and sales functions, makes Kargar a valuable addition to TVS Motor in its next phase of growth.

With an engineering degree from INSA Lyon in France and an MBA from London Business School, Kargar was most recently the Global Chairman and President of Infiniti, the luxury brand of Nissan. His previous roles include Vice-President of Sales and Marketing at the Renault Group, as well as Managing Director of Renault Middle East and Country Manager in Iran.

Kargar's elevation to TVS's top role also stems from the automaker's strong interna-



Peyman Kargar

tional business performance. Overseas markets now make up almost a third of the sales and are growing at over 30 per cent.

CHALLENGE AHEAD

Kranti Bathini, Director of Equity Strategy at WealthMills Securities, said that Kargar's immediate challenge will be to sustain the double-digit growth from a base of nearly six million vehicles while protecting the margins during an investment-heavy transition to EVs. "The benchmark is high because of what Radhakrishnan leaves behind. During his

tenure, TVS Motor strengthened domestic market share, accelerated exports and premiumisation and built electric and global platforms."

Sudarshan Venu, Chairman, TVS Motor, said, "Peyman is an accomplished leader with profound industry experience. I am confident he is the right person to lead TVS Motor Company and strengthen our position."

Interestingly, his brother Keyvan Kargar is also an automotive and industrial electronics veteran with stints in the Forvia Group and Renault, among others.

Peyman has dedicated his career to the industry, leading businesses, transforming organisations and bringing people together around a shared ambition, Keyvan said in a post on LinkedIn on Friday.

With inputs from Amit Vijay Mohile in Mumbai

QUICKLY.

ED freezes deposits worth ₹52 crore in DHFL case



New Delhi: The Enforcement Directorate (ED) on Friday said it has frozen bank deposits worth ₹51.75 crore under the anti-money laundering law as fresh action against an alleged bank loan fraud worth over ₹34,000 crore, linked to DHFL. The ED probe stems from a CBI FIR filed on a complaint from a consortium of 17 banks against DHFL and its promoters. [PTI](#)

Ola Electric bags ₹95.81 cr incentive for auto PLI

New Delhi: Ola Electric on Friday said it has received a sanction order from the Ministry of Heavy Industries for the release of incentives amounting to ₹95.81 crore under the PLI Scheme for Automobile and Auto Components. This is the second consecutive year in which Ola Electric has received an incentive, following the sanction of ₹366.78 crore in FY25. [PTI](#)

Chandra effect: Lenders turn wary of personal guarantees

THE WORRY. Under 3% of admitted claims of ₹2.78-lakh cr was approved in last six years

Suresh P Iyengar
Mumbai

The controversy surrounding Zee Group promoter Subhash Chandra's personal guarantee case will make lenders more cautious while pursuing similar cases involving Anil Ambani, Venugopal Dhoot and the legacy case of Sanjay Singhal, former promoter of Bhushan Power and Steel.

RECOVERY GAP

In the last six financial years, 4,203 cases against personal guarantors involving claims totalling ₹2.78 lakh crore were filed. Of these, resolution professionals were appointed in 1,832 cases, while 664 were admitted. Only 39 of these claims resulted in approved repayment plans, yielding creditors ₹129 crore, or 2.49 per cent of the admitted claims. The roots of the Chandra case go back to a ₹170 crore loan taken by Vivek Infracon, for which he had provided a personal guarantee. When

MAJOR EXPOSURES

- In June, NCLT Mumbai admitted SBI's personal insolvency proceedings against Anil Ambani to recover ₹1,200 crore against his alleged personal guarantees for loans to Reliance Communications, which entered into insolvency in 2019
- In April, an SBI-led consortium initiated personal insolvency proceedings against Venugopal Dhoot over an estimated ₹61,000-crore exposure linked to the erstwhile Videocon Group

the loan turned bad, Indi-abulls Housing Finance moved against Chandra, and the National Company Law Tribunal (NCLT) admitted the case in April 2024.

Total claims of ₹22,006 crore were admitted against Chandra for guaranteeing loans taken by several Essel and Zee-linked companies.

Chandra's guarantee applied to borrowing of about ₹2,574 crore of these claims, while the remaining guarantees were added later as extra security.

The underlying corporate borrowers remain liable for their debts, and lenders can still pursue recovery from

those companies, their pledged securities and other assets.

Chandra needs to pay ₹6.25 crore from his personal assets, while about ₹1,494 crore would come from the companies that originally borrowed the funds.

The NCLT verdict, which resulted in recovery of just ₹6.5 crore, tells a harsh story. For every ₹100 claimed, the approved plan offers roughly three paise to lenders.

GREATER SCRUTINY

Akshaya Bhanalsi, Managing Partner at Mindspright Legal, a law firm, said the verdict in the Chandra case

would make lenders more cautious in evaluating personal guarantees. It could lead to greater scrutiny of promoter net worth, asset tracing and the actual recoverability of guarantees, both at the time of sanctioning credit and when deciding the most effective recovery strategy, she said.

Kaushal Parsekar, Partner at King Stubb & Kasiva, Advocates and Attorneys, said, "The mere magnitude of the haircut, by itself, should not determine its validity. Any appellate court would examine specific facts, the statutory framework, the conduct of the creditors and guarantor, and whether the insolvency process had been correctly applied."

Amit Kumar Nag, Partner, Aquilaw, said the principal areas of contention going forward will be whether a substantial decline in net worth should trigger a mandatory independent valuation or verification before the creditors' vote, rather than only after the votes are cast, he said.

REIT fundraising soars in FY26 even as InvIT collections dip 21%

Yashaswani Chauhan
New Delhi

Fundraising through Real Estate Investment Trusts (REITs) nearly doubled to ₹9,300 crore in FY26, even as the number of issues remained low at three, indicating larger capital mobilisation through individual offerings. In contrast, Infrastructure Investment Trusts (InvITs), despite seeing an increase in the number of issues, saw fundraising decline by 21 per cent to ₹21,026 crore, per data sourced from SEBI reports.

DATA FOCUS.

In FY25, REITs raised ₹4,728 crore through two issues. Consequently, the average amount raised per issue in the year ended March 2026 rose 31 per cent to ₹3,100 crore from ₹2,364 crore a year ago. Even the year before, in FY24, only three issues were offered, collectively raising ₹5,905 crore. Fundraising has remained uneven over the years, peaking at ₹11,985 crore in FY21 before falling to ₹950 crore the next year.

SMALL TRANSACTIONS

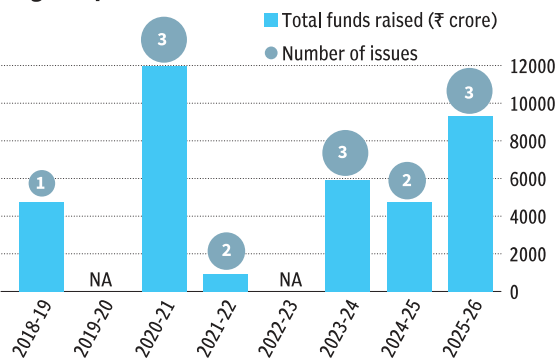
The larger issue sizes indicate that capital mobilisation is becoming more concentrated in individual REIT transactions. Chetan Chichra, Partner, Grant Thornton Bharat, said the rise in average issue size suggests that larger pools of institutional and long-term capital are being deployed through individual transactions, reflecting increasing maturity and investor comfort with the asset class.

InvITs, meanwhile, raised ₹21,026 crore in FY26, down from ₹26,714 crore in FY25 and ₹33,119 crore in FY24. The number of issues, however, increased to 12 in FY26 from 11 the year before. The fall in fundraising was mainly due to the dip in the average issue size. While it was ₹2,429 crore in FY25, it fell 28 per cent to ₹1,752 crore in the year that followed.

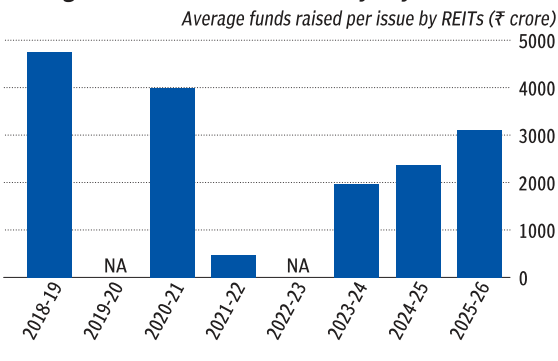
The divergence between the number of issues and funds raised suggests that InvIT fundraising is being spread across smaller transactions rather than being driven by a few larger issuances. Chichra said this reflects a more calibrated fundraising environment, with issuers raising capital through smaller transactions aligned with specific

Differing paths

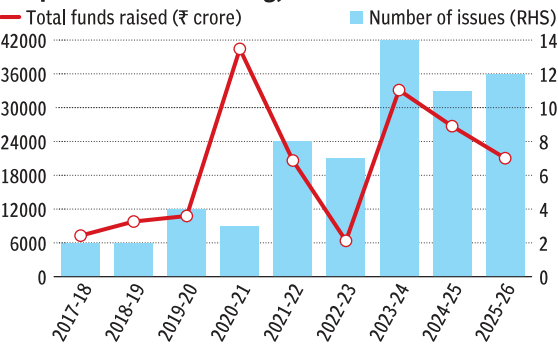
Fewer REIT issues indicate larger capital mobilisation



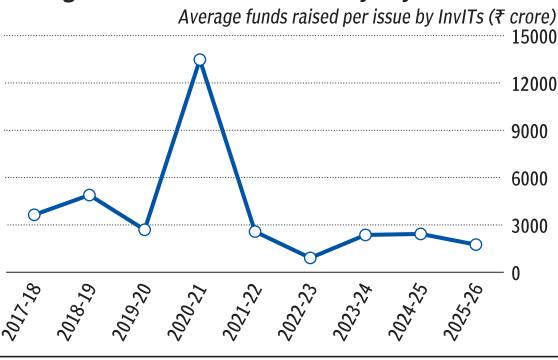
Average REIT issue size rises 31% y-o-y



Despite lower fundraising, InvIT issues rise 9%



Average InvIT issue size falls 28% y-o-y



Source: SEBI

funding requirements such as acquisitions, refinancing, or expansion.

Chanakya Chakravarti, Global Real Estate Investor and Capital Strategist, said the REIT numbers indicate a maturing market, with capital concentrating around larger platforms with established portfolios and predictable rental income.

For InvITs, the dip in fundraising should not necessarily be read as weaker investor appetite, but rather as a more asset-specific fun-

draising model in which sponsors monetise operating assets and recycle capital.

GROWTH DRIVERS

For FY27, Chakravarti expects both the segments to remain relevant, though their growth drivers are likely to differ. REITs could benefit from expanding commercial portfolios and demand for income-generating assets, while InvITs are expected to be supported by infrastructure investment and asset monetisation.

Noel Tata looking to swap shares in listed firms for Shapoorji's stake in Tata Sons

Bloomberg

The Tata Group is in talks with its biggest minority shareholder on proposals to unlock liquidity, including a potential swap of shares of its listed entities, as the Shapoorji Pallonji Group seeks funds to repay costly debt, according to people familiar with the matter.

Representatives of Noel Tata, the Tata family patriarch, are exploring the possibility where the SP Group receives shares of companies such as Tata Power in exchange for some or all of its 18.4 per cent stake in the privately-held Tata Sons, the people said.

OTHER OPTIONS

Two other options have also been presented: A direct buy-out of the construction giant's stake by Tata Sons, financed by overseas banks or a sale to an external investor, preferably a global one, the people added.

Any breakthrough on this



FINGERS CROSSED. Any breakthrough on this long-running tussle between the Tatas and the SP Group will prove to be a windfall for investors in the latter's debt [PTI](#)

long-running tussle between the Tatas and the SP Group will prove to be a windfall for investors in the latter's debt, which include the likes of Cerberus Capital Management LP, Davidson Kempner Capital Management, and Farallon Capital Management. For the Tatas, a resolution may ease some of the intense regulatory spotlight it has come under in the past few years after the RBI's rules revived pressure on its holding company to list on the exchanges.

Representatives of Tata Sons and the Shapoorji Pallonji Group did not offer any immediate comments.

SP Group closed one of the largest private-credit transactions in India in July as investors are hopeful that the conglomerate can eventually monetise its stake in Tata Sons and unlock liquidity worth crores of rupees.

WAIT AND WATCH

There's no certainty that the ongoing talks will lead to a deal and the structure of the

transaction may change as the negotiations proceed, the people said.

A major hurdle will be in agreeing at a valuation for Tata Sons that controls bulk of the sprawling salt-to-software conglomerate and has many large unlisted businesses such as Air India and i-phone maker Tata Electronics under its umbrella.

Both sides are evaluating legal aspects of all options being discussed as well as potential regulatory issues around the share swap since it will involve listed Tata entities, the people said.

A resolution needs to come through within the next 18 months as that's the timeline when the SP Group's recently closed bond issue will need to make its first payout. These bonds, sold by Equiszen Investment Private, offered 18.95 per cent and will mature in 36 months. But the first interest payment is coming up in July 2028, according to the bond term sheet seen by [Bloomberg](#).

Hero ups stake in Ather, invests ₹1,758 crore

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Two-wheeler maker Hero MotoCorp on Friday said the company is purchasing additional equity shares in EV maker Ather Energy, valued at up to ₹1,758 crore. The transaction, approved by its Committee of Directors, will be funded entirely through cash consideration.

The company is purchasing the shares from an existing shareholder of Ather rather than through a fresh issue, it said in a stock exchange filing. The transaction is expected to close by September 3, and does not require any governmental or regulatory approvals, according to the filing.

With this, Hero MotoCorp's shareholding in Ather is expected to rise to around 32.8 per cent from 29.88 per cent currently, on a fully diluted basis. Ather's financials have consistently grown over the years. Its FY26 turnover stood at ₹3,671.76 crore.

Ambuja Neotia to invest ₹2,200 cr in hospital arm

Our Bureau
Kolkata

The Ambuja Neotia Group is planning to add around 1,800 beds across eight upcoming healthcare facilities in the next four to five years at an investment of around ₹2,200 crore. The healthcare vertical of the Kolkata-based group, Ambuja Neotia Healthcare Venture (AN-HVL), currently has four facilities across West Bengal and Assam with around 700 beds.

ANHVL is looking to operationalise a 120-bed woman and child care facility in West Bengal's Howrah district by April 2029 with an outlay of around ₹150 crore.

GROWTH CORRIDOR

"We currently have eight projects under development in eastern India. We are planning to add around 1,800 beds across these eight upcoming healthcare facilities to increase total number of beds to around 2,500 in the next four to five years," Parthiv Neotia, Managing Director, Ambuja Neotia, said on Friday.

"Our endeavour has always been to make quality healthcare more accessible to communities across the region. The upcoming facility in Howrah is a significant step in that direction. While our existing healthcare facilities are spanning across



Parthiv Neotia, Managing Director, Ambuja Neotia

various locations in Kolkata, Siliguri and Guwahati, we identified Howrah as a key growth corridor with a growing need for specialised women and child healthcare services," Neotia added.

ASSET-LIGHT MODEL

For its upcoming woman and child care facility in West Bengal's Durgapur, ANHVL has partnered with Amit Metaliks, which will provide land and construct the facility. "This ₹100-crore project is under construction. We expect to start the facility in the next 18 months," Neotia said. Amit Metaliks operates in the steel, mining and infrastructure sectors.

Going forward, the group aims to explore the possibility of such an "asset-light model" for some of its new healthcare projects. "We are open to finding partners. We are actively looking at many of the regional markets in the East," said Neotia.

JSW MG Motor India seeks lower taxes on plug-in hybrid EVs

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

JSW MG Motor India has called for lower taxation on plug-in hybrids and plans to bring extended-range EVs to India as it widens its new-energy technology play. This, even as JSW Group's ₹40,000-crore Odisha EV and battery project, including a planned 50 GWh battery plant, remains on hold while it searches for an LFP cell-technology partner.

"We would love to see a tax reduction for plug-in hybrid electric vehicles (PHEVs)," said Parth Jindal, scion of the JSW Group, and Director on the Board and a Steering Committee Member of JSW MG Motor India.

THE TAX GAP

Pure EVs attract 5 per cent GST, while larger PHEVs can face 28 per cent GST plus compensation cess, thereby substantially increasing their effective indirect-tax burden. Jindal acknowledged the government's rationale: because a PHEV's petrol engine can directly drive the wheels, it is treated as an internal-combustion vehicle.

But he pointed to JSW's newly launched Hector Tomahawk to illustrate the price consequence. Its PHEV version could effectively have been priced alongside



Don't make it 12 per cent... But consumers should get it cheap

PARTH JINDAL
Director, JSW MG Motor India



the battery-electric Tomahawk but for the difference in taxation, he added.

He stopped short of seeking the same tax treatment as a pure EV, instead floating a middle ground. "Don't make it 12 per cent, make it 18 per cent... But consumers should get it cheap," Jindal said.

The Tomahawk PHEV has a 20.5 kWh battery, more than 115 km of claimed electric-only range, and a combined petrol-electric range exceeding 1,100 km. MG sees such vehicles as a bridge for customers who can make much of their everyday travel on electricity but do not want to depend entirely on charging infrastructure for longer journeys.

MG bets that India's transition will be a spectrum: Battery EVs (BEVs) for buyers ready to depend on charging and PHEVs for those wanting electric commuting without sacrificing long-distance flexibility.

That said, MG now in-

tends to bring extended range EVs (EREVs) to India. "We can bring, and I mean we want to bring," Jindal said, adding that he expects the technology to become popular in the country.

BATTERY HURDLE

Battery cells remain a key gap in MG's localisation push.

JSW Group's ₹40,000-crore Odisha project envisages a 50 GWh battery plant alongside other investments. The project has been put on hold while JSW searches for an LFP cell-technology partner.

businessline.

Disclaimer: Readers are requested to verify & make appropriate enquiries to satisfy themselves about the veracity of an advertisement before responding to any published in this newspaper. THG PUBLISHING PVT LTD., the Publisher & Owner of this newspaper, does not vouch for the authenticity of any advertisement or advertiser or for any of the advertiser's products and/or services. In no event can the Owner, Publisher, Printer, Editor, Director/s, Employees of this newspaper/company be held responsible/liable in any manner whatsoever for any claims and/or damages for advertisements in this newspaper.

QUICKLY.

All-new Pulsar 125 and 150 mark 25 years of the brand



Bajaj has begun its 25-year celebration of the Pulsar by launching two all-new motorcycles, the Pulsar 125 and the Pulsar 150. Featuring new tech, along with a brand-new engine, gearbox, chassis and monoshock, and with bodywork that's a modernised take on yesteryear Pulsars, the new motorcycles are substantially different from their predecessors. The Pulsar 125 is priced ₹92,990, while prices for the Pulsar 150 range from ₹1.15 lakh to ₹1.23 lakh (all prices ex-showroom).

Honda Rebel 300 makes India debut at ₹2.22 lakh



The Rebel was among the most anticipated motorcycles in recent times and it's finally been launched in India at ₹2.22 lakh (standard variant). The Rebel 300 features a 286 cc single-cylinder liquid-cooled engine, a 6-speed gearbox and a power output of 29.5 bhp. There's an e-clutch variant, too, which allows for gearshifts without having to use the clutch lever, and it's priced ₹2.62 lakh (ex-showroom, Bengaluru).

BMW launches the X1 LWB in India with more comfort



The long-wheelbase version of the fourth-generation X1 has been launched at ₹49.9 lakh (ex-showroom), and it undercuts the existing X1 (short wheelbase) by a lakh. The X1 LWB scores high on backseat comfort and on its feature suite and is available exclusively with a 1.5-litre petrol engine, which produces 154.2 bhp. As a result of its pricing, the X1 LWB now serves as the entry point into the X1 range, which includes the short-wheelbase X1 and the electric iX1 LWB.

@TheMotorGram

The Prize of Cool

YELLOW FEVER. The Land Rover Defender Trophy Edition is anything but subtle. And yet, it might just be the most sensible of the lot



PRASHANT SHETTY

Ruman Devmane

For precisely two decades, between 1980 and 2000, there existed a competition you were happy to simply survive. The Camel Trophy wasn't exactly a race but rather a most intense test of man and machine over relentlessly gruelling terrain. What began in Brazil featuring three German teams armed with Jeeps quickly became Land Rover's domain and, in later years, extended as far as to Sumatra and even Siberia.

The Defender Trophy Edition is a hat-tip to that era of Land Rover's most iconic years as a focused off-road carmaker, long before it became the preferred chariot of the ridiculously affluent. Of course, the 'Camel' prefix couldn't be revived given strict tobacco advertising regulations; it was, in fact, the onset of this very framework that killed the Camel Trophy back in 2000 as well, other than Land Rover's own compulsions to pull the plug on it. That's in the past, though.

WIN WIN

Today, Land Rover has every reason to celebrate, given just how tremendous a success the Defender has been globally. And while there may be fewer takers for a competition as intense as the Camel Trophy, those in the know never stopped longing for the revival of that iconic livery. The Trophy Edition is, for now, exclusively reserved for the Defender 110 variant — the 90 really deserves it, too, I think — and you can only have one with a rather brilliant diesel engine.

Other Defenders can be had with either a 2.0-litre four-cylinder or a 5.0-litre V8 (both petrol), but the Trophy's 3.0-litre inline-six diesel, also available on other versions, is perhaps the most compelling one. More on that later.

For Trophy money, what you get

is essentially a very evocative paint scheme and some really cool equipment. It's not as if a Defender of any sort fails to turn heads in India, which speaks volumes for its design appeal, given that it's essentially a six-year-old car that was only face-lifted sometime ago, but the Trophy is an immediate attention magnet.

The expanse of yellow offset with black trim, its purposeful 20-inch steel rims, a host of add-ons in the form of the external 'panniers', a side step and a seemingly over-engineered roof rack all come together to give the Trophy unbeatable road presence. This one should have been called the 'Attacker', perhaps!

PLUSH POINT

On the inside, you'll find no changes to the layout, which is a good thing because the Defender's is as practical a cabin as you'll ever find in a luxury off-roader. There's a multitude of physical buttons on the steering wheel and dash, the infotainment screen is large and slick (and still doesn't dominate your view), and the only new bit is the use of yellow surfaces in the dashboard inset and across the door trim. This last bit had every reason to appear childish, but with the right use of quality materials it just looks so cool!

A few more 'tactical' bits may have spruced up the cabin to go with the Trophy theme, but what those might've been I can't say. A cleverly concealed dagger or an AI-powered mine-extractor, maybe?

On comfort, the Trophy scores really high. The seats are fantastic (I did two 500-km driving days in it and would have happily done a third), the ergonomics and outward visibility are fantastic, and the ride quality is really impressive for a car that doesn't need to behave. Sure, it shows its bulk in corners by producing noticeable body roll, but knowing what it can accomplish over awful terrain, its composure is truly



READY TO RAID. The Trophy's cabin features premium but hardy materials. External 'panniers' are great to store off-road-soiled items but slightly impede rear view. The steel wheels look cool! PRASHANT SHETTY

admirable. This is not a small or light vehicle by any means, okay?

Over small speed bumps or potholes, you'll barely hear a thing in the cabin and, while this goes without saying, even over the roughest roads, the Trophy simply goes about its business nonchalantly. Air suspension is a paid extra, using which you can raise its ride height even further and in an instant, although I wish it were offered as standard on a car meant to serve as a tribute to among the most hardcore chapters of Land Rover's legacy. I really liked driving it with the suspension raised to its

highest — that feeling was just irresistible — although the ride height drops to its normal setting the moment you exceed 80 kph, which is sensible.

Party tricks aside, the Trophy still is a thoroughly enjoyable car to drive. That six-cylinder diesel engine is a treat in every way, naturally for the incredible amount of torque (71.3 kg-m) it delivers but also for being surprisingly efficient if you can get yourself to drive it gently. On a tankful of diesel, it can comfortably get you past 600 km and, on instances, it even relayed an average fuel consumption of as much as

11 kpl on its MID. Realistically, you can expect it to deliver 8-9 kpl in a mixed driving cycle.

GOING FOR GOLD

What impresses most about the diesel is its tractability and power delivery. This is a punchy engine that produces 345.2 bhp, and it can propel the Trophy to 100 kph from standstill in under 7 seconds.

The performance it delivers under aggressive driving is far from sedate; if you thought drama was solely the domain of the V8-engined Octa, you couldn't be further from the truth. It's also an extremely refined engine which, paired with the smooth 8-speed gearbox, makes for a well-rounded driving experience.

On a liveability index, this engine would score the highest among all the others you can have in a Defender. Obviously, the Trophy must be phenomenal off-road, right? Must be. I simply wasn't feeling brave enough to try. Never mind the friendly forewarning from Land Rover to 'keep off-roading light,' I simply don't see why anyone would want to drive a ₹1.3 crore (ex-showroom) car off the road, curiosity aside. Sure, it might look great on Instagram, but for once I think it's a good thing I have so few followers.

Never mind the tiny inconvenience in the form of the dash cam our test car came equipped with. Have fun watching a 1,200 km road trip in 4k resolution, Land Rover.

What the Trophy is, is a really special car to travel and make memories with. It's fun and iconic, even if constrained by compliances, and its charm extends far beyond its capabilities. If buying a Defender and not being discreet about it was on your agenda this weekend, the Trophy Edition deserves a hike to your friendly neighbourhood Land Rover dealership. And count me in for a day of proper mud-plugging too!

@TheMotorGram

The E-ternal flame



MODERN ARISTOCRACY. The Mercedes-Benz E220d does understated elegance like nothing else, as we drive it to find out if the E-Class nameplate can still hold its own

PREMIUM APPEAL. The spacious cabin feels opulent and tastefully designed, while high screen dependence can feel laborious, though the ample boot space, featuring a space-saver spare wheel, adds practicality YASH GAWDE

Ruman Devmane

In recent years, the Mercedes-Benz E-Class has moved away from making headlines. It's not the kind of car that feels the need to grab attention and that's exactly the kind of buyer it attracts as well. The E-Class is a no-nonsense formula for when you've decided that life is about

much more than being the talk of the town. In a way, the E-Class isn't a car you buy, it's what you become.

Cruising at the expressway speed limit on a rainy morning, I was surprised at how quiet the E220d's cabin felt. The tachometer needle was barely above its resting spot and there was no indication that the car I happened to be piloting down the highway was diesel-powered. While its 2.0-litre four-cylinder engine pro-

duces a respectable 194.4 bhp, it feels more at home being driven in a stately manner rather than spiritedly. So, rather than digging for an outwardly sporty flavour, I instead derived great satisfaction from the DTE indicator, which stated I had 1,094 km to go before needing a refuel. The only thing amiss was a chauffeur, which denied me the chance to sprawl out in the backseat before the eventual-ity of a deep slumber would arrive.

PRACTICAL CAR

It's been around for a while, of course, but having only recently gotten my hands on it, I was quite keen to spend time with a car that boasts among the world's most revered nameplates. The E-Class rests on a long-standing reputation of being a dependable luxury sedan and this E220d, with its manners and subtle opulence, was making a point rather effortlessly. This still is — yes, despite all of the

world's attempts at reinventing the wheel — a perfectly practical car with a seemingly natural ability to deliver premiumness.

In the front row, your view is most certainly dominated by the three screens, which also feature many of the important controls. I wish it weren't that way because it just gets in the way of the otherwise sublime and intuitive driving experience the E220d has to offer. Outward visibility is just fant-

astic, courtesy the large glass areas and the front-row seating is beautifully configured for long driving days.

The seats offer great support and adjustability, although the exclusion of ventilation is a sore miss. The backseat is, undoubtedly, the star of the show with its reclining backrest and tremendous legroom. However, set against an SUV-dominated world, ingress and egress can feel



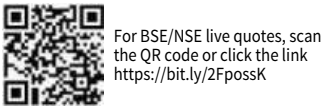
a bit challenging given its inherently low stance (as a sedan, that is). The seat base is well-designed, offering great under-thigh support and the centre armrest feels substantial and well-appointed. There's also an excellent ambient lighting suite, which is a sight to behold at night!

COMFORT CLASS

On less-than-ideal roads, the E220d is remarkably composed and while you can feel the relative (to an SUV — sigh!) lack of suspension travel, it still offers a fairly plush ride. On a great road, the E220d will convince you it's all the car you'll ever need. While it may be a step (or two) lower than the S-Class, mechanically speaking, it has inherited the same character of wafting in a great manner that makes it immensely endearing. Watch out for ill-designed speed breakers, though! On the whole, it's a really easy car to drive, in the city or otherwise. I, for one, admire the respectful distance the E220d maintains from aggression; that may be fun in short bursts, but over a long day of business travel, and an even longer tenure of ownership, comfort is what will mean much more to you.

A couple of years ago, I grudged it the lack of screens for the rear row, but given how much I don't want to look at a screen any more, it now feels like a very good thing. With its ₹83.5 lakh (ex-showroom) price tag, the E-Class faces competition from all quarters, including its own siblings, but buying one is still among the wisest calls you'll ever make.

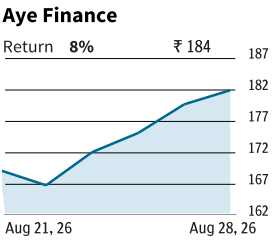
@TheMotorGram



For BSE/NSE live quotes, scan the QR code or click the link
https://bit.ly/2fpossk

QUICKLY.

Alpha Wave Global exits Aye Finance via block deal



New Delhi: Alpha Wave Global has exited from Aye Finance, by divesting its entire 7.78 per cent stake in the micro-enterprise lender for ₹322 crore through a series of block deals on the BSE. Alpha Wave India I LP, an affiliate of the New York-based alternative asset manager, sold more than 1.91 crore shares in two tranches, at prices ranging from ₹168.02 to ₹168.19 apiece, according to data on the BSE. A mix of domestic and foreign institutional investors, including US-based Millenium Management and veteran investor Madhusudan Kela's Singularity AMC bought shares at the same price. **PTI**

Annu Projects public issue subscribed nearly 3x

Bengaluru: Annu Projects IPO was subscribed 2.93 times on Friday, led by demand from non-institutional investors. The NII portion was subscribed 3.55 times, followed by the retail portion at 2.68 times and the QIB quota at 1.72 times. The company had a fixed a price range of ₹94-99 a share for its ₹175-crore initial public offering. It comprised a fresh issue of 1,76,83,000 shares. The company plans to utilise ₹115 crore of the IPO proceeds for funding working capital requirements. Another ₹15 crore will be used for capital expenditure requirements for the purchase of machinery or equipment, while the remainder will be utilised for general corporate purposes. **OUR BUREAU**

IT stocks aid Nifty recovery, focus on Federal Reserve Chair's cues

RENEWED INTEREST. TCS, Tech Mahindra and Infosys score handsome gains, following Nvidia strong results

Anupama Ghosh
Mumbai

The benchmarks ended the week on a positive note on Friday, snapping a two-session losing streak, as a global technology rally, sparked by Nvidia's blowout quarterly results and upbeat revenue outlook, sent domestic IT stocks surging, masking an otherwise cautious and range-bound session.

"IT is emerging as the top outperformer, tracking global technology gains after Nvidia's strong quarterly results and upbeat revenue outlook," said Ajit Mishra, SVP Research, Religare Broking.

With the prevailing geo-political uncertainty, the fo-

cus now shifts to Federal Reserve Chair Kevin Warsh's remarks at the Jackson Hole symposium, he said.

The Nifty 50 closed at 24,175, 0.35 per cent, while the Sensex settled at 77,264, gaining 0.43 per cent.

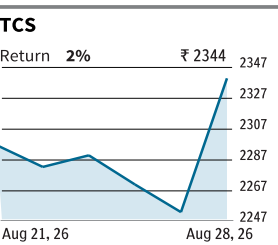
The Nifty IT index led sectoral gains, surging 3.5 per cent on Friday, with TCS, Tech Mahindra and Infosys among the top Nifty 50 gainers. Metals and pharma also ended in the green.

FMCG, auto and energy faced selling pressure and closed in the red.

The Bank Nifty ended nearly flat, slipping 0.02 per cent to 57,496.

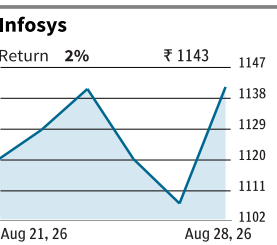
SECTOR-SPECIFIC

The session's advance was largely sector-specific. The



broader markets tracked the benchmark modestly, with the Nifty Midcap 100 edging up 0.05 per cent and the Nifty Smallcap 100 gaining 0.2 per cent, the latter continuing to trade near all-time highs.

The advance-decline ratio improved to 1.25, though within the Nifty 500 universe, 286 stocks ended in the red against 207 in the green. NSE cash turnover



slipped 4 per cent from the previous session. For the week, the Nifty fell 0.3 per cent, marking its third straight weekly decline.

Sentiment also drew support from a pause in the West Asia tensions and a rebound in FII inflows during the month.

Ankur Punj, Managing Director, Equirus Wealth, noted that investors had been "steadily increasing ex-

posure to equity assets amid rebound in FII inflows".

On the macro data front, India's Index of Industrial Production grew 6.7 per cent year-on-year in July 2026, easing from an upward-revised 8.8 per cent in June. "The deceleration was broad-based and was partly driven by an adverse base," said Rahul Agrawal, Principal Economist, ICRA.

Manufacturing output growth slowed to 7.3 per cent from 9.5 per cent, though capital goods expanded in double digits for the fourth consecutive month, and consumer durables output surged 10.5 per cent.

Looking ahead, all eyes will be on Warsh's address at the Jackson Hole symposium over the weekend.

SEBI issues observations on NSE's IPO draft papers

Akshata Gorde
Mumbai

The Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) has issued observations on the draft papers filed by the National Stock Exchange (NSE) for its long-awaited initial public offering.

The regulator has issued observations to the NSE on August 21 and is awaiting a response from the exchanges' lead manager.

The update comes a day after SEBI Chairman Tuhin Kanta Pandey said the market regulator was "close" to approving the NSE's draft papers.

The NSE had filed its draft red herring prospectus with SEBI in June for an offer for sale of up to 148.9 million shares with a face value of ₹1 each, representing nearly 6 per cent of its paid-up capital.

The NSE's listing plans have been in the works for

years and had faced regulatory hurdles for the last decade, including issues related to the co-location and dark fibre cases. The exchange's IPO plans gained momentum after SEBI gave it a no-objection certificate earlier this year. Last month, the regulator in-principle agreed to settle the applications filed by the NSE in the co-location and dark fibre matters for ₹1,491.21 crore.

The stock is currently trading at a valuation of around ₹5 lakh crore in the unlisted market and is expected to be one of the largest IPOs by size, at around ₹30,000 crore.

The exchange has appointed 20 book-running lead managers, including Kotak Mahindra Capital, which is the coordinating lead manager.

Once SEBI completes its review and clears the draft papers, NSE can proceed with the next steps towards launching the IPO.

Tempsens clocks biggest listing gain of 110% in 2026, closes at ₹586.65 vs IPO price of ₹300

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

Tempsens Instruments (India) shares jumped over 110 per cent to ₹631.2 on the BSE and ₹634 on the NSE on their market debut against the IPO price of ₹300, marking the biggest listing gain on the exchanges this year.

After Sigachi Industries' 250 per cent gains in 2021, this is the second highest on the mainboard.

The stock, however, settled a tad weak at ₹586.80 and ₹586.65 on the BSE and the NSE, a gain of nearly 96 per cent over the IPO price. Swastika Investmart's



A PERFECT TON. (from left) Priyanka Menaria, CFO, Vinay Rathi, MD, and Aryan Rathi, Lead, Global Sales of Tempsens Instruments (India), at the listing ceremony

Shivani Nyati said Tempsens Instruments' strong debut reflects its category leadership, financial growth, healthy margins and favourable industrial indigenisation themes. However, she

cautioned that the sharp listing-day rise had pushed valuations significantly above historical averages, while sector cyclicality, manufacturing concentration in Udaipur and rising working

capital remain key risks.

IPO DETAILS

The ₹650-crore IPO of the thermal engineering and specialised cable manufacturer was subscribed 184.07 times, as all category investors poured in money.

Ahead of the IPO, Tempsens Instruments raised ₹194.55 crore from anchor investors. The IPO comprised a fresh issue of ₹95 crore and an OFS of ₹555 crore. The Udaipur-based company plans to use the proceeds for capital expenditure in electrical heating and specialised cable solutions, debt repayment and general corporate purposes.

BROKER'S CALL.

JM Financial

TATA POWER (BUY)

Target: ₹422
CMP: ₹351.65
Tata Power's longstanding dispute with Kleros Capital is back in focus after a Singapore court rejected the former's challenge to arbitral awards issued last year. Kleros Capital and Tata Power had signed an NDA in 2013 to explore coal mining in Russia to source lower-cost coal for its Mundra plant. The partnership later broke down, after which Tata Power obtained the mining licence independently through a Russian subsidiary in 2018. Kleros alleged that Tata Power breached its confidentiality obligations and commenced arbitration proceedings in Nov'20. Meanwhile, the coal exploration project of Tata Power also did not advance. The tribunal held Tata Power liable for breaching NDA and directed it to pay \$490 million in damages with interest. Tata Power appealed to Singapore International Commercial Court (SICC) to set aside the SIAC arbitral award, but the appeal was rejected. Tata Power has 28 days to appeal to Singapore Court of Appeal (SCA). We estimate a provision of ₹6,000 crore (\$650 million), representing 4-5 per cent of our target valuation. We maintain Buy with a target price of ₹422 (earlier ₹444), factoring in FY26 actuals.

Choice Broking

VARUN BEVERAGES (BUY)

Target: ₹550
CMP: ₹414
Varun Beverages Ltd's (VBL) growth rests on two levers. In India, the opportunity is penetration led where VBL reaches only about four million of an estimated 12 million FMCG outlets and per capita consumption (7 litres) remains a fraction of the global level (31 litres), leaving a multi year runway even as Reliance's Campa and Coca-Cola compete intensely. In international markets, increasingly Africa centric, VBL has methodically built scale through a mix of greenfield entry (DRC, Kenya) and bolt-on M&A (BevCo, Twizza, Crickley Dairy in South Africa), lifting International's share of revenue from 20 per cent in CY21 to 33 per cent in CY25 and expects 40 per cent by CY28. We initiate coverage with a 'Buy' rating and a target price of ₹550, valuing the stock at 40x Sep-28E EPS. Upside triggers: Faster international scale-up and margin convergence, alongside continued India volume growth and visi-cooler penetration; and premiumisation and portfolio diversification through energy drink, dairy, snacks and new adjacencies such as Calpis, Carlsberg and proposed entry into RTD alcoholic beverages. **Key Risks:** Rising competitive intensity and adverse weather conditions; slower than expected international margin convergence toward India levels; slower than expected scaling of new categories and adjacencies, including dairy, snacks, Calpis and AlcoBev; and Regulatory risk pertaining over product categorisation, formulation standards, and misleading labelling.

businessline is not responsible for the recommendations sourced from third party brokerages. Reports may be sent to: blmarketwatch@gmail.com

Waves of old economy, niche players buoy IPO market

RINGSIDE VIEW.

KS BADRI NARAYANAN

The Indian primary market has been buzzing in recent years, emerging as one of the most active IPO markets globally, with the number of issues crossing 350 annually. Both the mainboard and SME segments have attracted a growing pool of companies and investors.

Traditionally, IPO activity tends to peak when the secondary market is thriving and benchmark indices are scaling new highs. But this cycle has been different. Even as the Nifty and the Sensex have largely moved sideways, there has been little let-up in primary-market activity. The SME segment, in particular, has witnessed a relentless run, underscoring a growing appetite for smaller, niche businesses.

INDUSTRIAL PLAYERS

Old-economy sectors — traditional industries with roots in the Industrial Revolution, centred on physical goods, heavy manufacturing and

manual labour — are making a strong return to the capital markets. In earlier years, IPOs tended to chase whichever theme was in vogue at the time — IT, telecom, infrastructure or financial services. This cycle is different: companies spanning steel and coal, textiles, power, recycling and metals are all increasingly finding their way to the market.

For instance, several old-economy players have tapped the market, including Lumino Industries, Annu Projects and Laser Power & Infra (EPC); Kusumgar and Aastha Spintex (textiles); Ardee Industries (metal recycling); Indo-MIM and Hy-Tech Engineers (high-precision engineered components and assemblies); GSP Crop Science (agrochemicals); Behari Lal Engineering (iron and steel); Shiprocket, Horizon Industrial and LEAP India (logistics); MV Electrosystems (electrical and power electronics equipment); and Augmont Enterprises (an integrated gold and silver platform).

FIRST-OF-A KIND

At the other end of the spectrum, several niche players



BACK WITH A BANG. Both the mainboard and SME platforms of the stock exchanges have attracted several IPOs from companies in the old-economy sector **GETTY IMAGES**

have also entered the market recently. These include Tempsens Instruments (a thermal engineering and specialised cable manufacturing company); Gaja Alternative (the first alternative investment fund company to tap the market); Rays of Belief (a for-profit social enterprise that delivers personalised therapy and early-intervention programmes for children with neurodevelopmental disorders, including autism); and Kwick Forensic Solutions Ltd (a forensic science and digital solutions firm on the SME platform).

While Sify Infinit Spaces Ltd, the first pure-play data

centre company, deferred its public issue plans, the IPO of ESDS Software Solution, a cloud, data centre and AI ecosystem provider, is currently under way.

It is also heartening to see high-profile, institution-backed companies such as Sedemac Mechatronics (IIT Bombay), Indo-MIM Ltd (IIT Madras) and Ather Energy (IIT Madras) tap the capital markets. Companies from Rajasthan, Madhya Pradesh and Bihar, have also launched IPOs on the mainboard of the exchanges.

INDIA LEADS

The divergence signals a

shift. India's IPO market is no longer merely riding broader market momentum. It is being powered by a wider and more diverse set of companies tapping public capital.

The message from subscription levels is unambiguous — with most IPOs heavily oversubscribed, demand for primary-market offerings remains strong and sustained.

However, a SEBI study in 2024 found that about 54 per cent of IPO shares (in value terms) allotted to investors, excluding anchor investors, were sold within a week of listing.

Individual investors sold 50.2 per cent of their allotted shares within a week of listing. Investors come to IPOs with different aims. Some are drawn by the prospect of short-term listing gains; others are in it for the long haul. The approach ultimately depends on an individual's financial goals and risk appetite.

One thing is clear: India's primary market is rapidly emerging as a global growth engine, drawing companies, investors and capital from across sectors and geographies. One hopes the trend will continue.

SEBI suggests easing merchant banker rule for small-value debt issues

Our Bureau
Mumbai

The Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) has proposed granting an exemption from mandatory appointment of a merchant banker for small-value debt issued by listed companies through a private placement in order to reduce compliance costs and boost market development.

The current rule requires issuers to appoint at least one merchant banker for private placements of debt securities or non-convertible redeemable preference shares with a face value of ₹10,000.

The mandatory appointment of merchant bankers increases costs, causes delays



and hurts price-sensitive debt issuances where market yields can move quickly. Further, the limited number of merchant bankers active in the debt segment is also a hindrance, SEBI said, inviting public comments by September 17.

STRICT CRITERIA

The exemption is restricted to issuers meeting four con-

ditions, such as being registered with or regulated by a financial sector regulator, including SEBI, RBI, the Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India or the PFRDA.

The issuer must also have been listed on a recognised stock exchange for at least one year and have no pending fines or penalties from SEBI or the stock exchanges for applicable listing-related non-compliance.

Additionally, the issuer must not have defaulted in the last three financial years and the current financial year regarding the repayment of deposits or interest payable on them. The issuer must also submit an auditor's certificate confirming this to the stock exchange.

Nifty 50 Movers						▲ 84.80 pts.
	Close(₹)	Pts	PE	WN(%)		
HDFC Bank	720.30	31.12	13.44	9.97		
Infosys	1144.00	25.45	15.31	3.63		
TCS	2342.00	20.88	16.93	2.16		
HCL Tech	1236.10	7.26	20.49	1.25		
Tech Mahindra	1640.90	7.76	31.15	0.94		
Reliance Ind	1287.00	7.09	19.75	7.86		
Axis Bank	1265.00	5.65	14.08	3.28		
L&T	4045.80	4.81	28.36	4.28		
Bajaj Auto	11910.00	4.60	28.81	1.19		
Hindalco	1037.40	4.24	34.22	1.36		
State Bank	1047.50	4.15	10.78	3.91		
Bharti Airtel	1882.40	2.72	31.50	5.17		
Titan	5169.20	2.70	79.67	1.93		
Wipro	180.95	2.69	13.49	0.44		
Grasim Ind	3290.00	2.64	19.68	1.12		
Sun Pharma	1920.00	1.55	38.02	1.84		
Tata Motors PV	319.40	1.55	0.00	0.60		
Trent Ltd.	2898.00	1.42	85.16	0.87		
PowerGrid Corp	266.05	1.14	15.57	1.09		
Apollo Hosp	8838.50	0.87	58.51	0.82		
Max Healthcare	1014.10	0.83	67.72	0.68		
M&M	3344.00	0.78	20.48	2.69		
Nestle India	1454.60	0.73	73.60	0.94		
Bharat Elec	411.90	0.70	48.98	1.33		
Coal India	401.00	0.52	7.92	0.87		
Cipla	1423.50	0.43	34.27	0.72		
Hind Unilever	2010.40	0.27	45.01	1.61		
Jio Financial Services Ltd.	238.40	0.22	76.18	0.71		
ONGC	323.25	0.21	6.52	0.82		
Dr Reddy's Lab	1178.00	0.13	30.89	0.65		
HDFC Life	548.00	0.00	59.87	0.53		
Adani Enter	3168.50	-0.03	54.87	0.83		
TataConsumerProduct	1040.70	-1.18	62.71	0.61		
JSW Steel	1334.90	-0.53	11.66	1.13		
Tata Steel	186.50	-0.54	20.67	1.39		
Eternal Ltd.	238.00	-0.73	38.32	1.04		
Kotak Bank	423.70	-0.80	20.76	2.82		
NTPC	330.05	-0.88	11.30	1.41		
Adani Ports	1707.50	-1.05	29.98	1.14		
Bajaj Finserv	2002.00	-1.14	15.53	1.05		
Int'lGlobeAvi	5166.00	-1.14	0.00	1.06		
SBI Life	1761.10	-1.54	67.93	0.72		
Eicher Motors	8059.00	-1.23	38.12	1.00		
Bajaj Finance	1079.90	-1.82	32.56	2.62		
Maruti Suzuki	13376.00	-1.82	29.34	1.58		
Asian Paints	2608.70	-2.20	51.73	1.07		
UltraTech Cement	11589.00	-3.31	39.84	1.24		
Shriram Finance Ltd.	106.90	-4.32	22.59	1.38		
ITC	266.00	-6.32	16.51	2.32		
ICICI Bank	1422.80	-31.62	17.08	9.21		

Nifty Next 50 Movers						▼ 188.30 pts.
	Close(₹)	Pts	PE	WN(%)		
Divis Lab	9239.00	66.11	83.85	4.60		
Ltimindtree	4675.00	56.95	26.68	1.70		
Vedanta	287.95	34.25	6.74	1.91		
Macrochem Developers	1274.00	22.33	30.83	1.38		
Torrent Pharma	5050.00	21.74	89.09	2.90		
Hindus Zinc	622.00	16.63	15.40	1.17		
Jindal Steel	1179.20	9.90	44.41	1.71		
Union Bank	186.00	8.42	6.88	1.41		
Bpcl	319.25	7.36	8.08	2.54		
DII	679.80	6.80	37.85	1.71		
Hyundai Motor India	2267.00	5.80	37.21	1.27		
Bank Of Baroda	241.90	4.85	6.80	1.76		
Britannia Ind	5308.50	3.59	48.99	2.45		
Abb India	7509.00	2.90	102.32	1.54		
Canara Bank	128.35	2.05	5.87	1.69		
MuthootFin	3091.00	1.87	10.83	1.30		
Ambuja Cements	412.05	1.81	19.74	1.01		
ZydusIntelligence	1191.00	1.31	26.09	1.17		
Cummins India	5193.00	1.18	60.81	2.75		
Punjab Natl Bank	115.40	0.00	5.99	1.56		
Tata Capital	375.70	-0.44	29.11	0.74		
Tata Power	351.85	-0.73	21.39	2.30		
Siemens	4089.00	-1.54	100.23	1.92		
Bosch	4864.00	-3.53	60.70	1.65		
Siemens Energy India	3242.60	-3.55	77.60	1.12		
Hdfc Amc	2569.00	-3.55	37.36	2.05		
Indian Railway Finance Corp	83.90	-4.38	15.25	2.66		
Indian Oilcorp	137.10	-5.10	5.42	2.01		
Sarmaradhiethersoninternat	165.60	-5.14	38.37	2.87		
Mazagon Dock	2555.00	-7.29	36.11	0.76		
Bajaj Holdings	11340.00	-7.42	14.03	1.92		
Avenueusuper	3836.60	-7.87	81.72	2.24		
Godrej Consumer	915.00	-9.34	24.93	1.47		
United Spirits	1510.00	-10.30	65.10	1.75		
Gail (India)	177.10	-10.50	11.40	1.81		
Solar Industries	20400.00	-12.74	90.03	1.95		
Rural Elec	316.80	-14.88	5.20	1.55		
CholamandalamInFin	1862.90	-15.72	20.61	3.72		
Power Finance	35.20	-16.29	3.45	2.01		
AdaniRenewenergy	1311.00	-17.05	176.63	1.56		
CG Power & Ind Sol	889.00	-17.73	113.09	2.39		
Shree Cement	24000.00	-18.66	52.93	1.26		
Venus Beverages	1414.00	-18.87	34.68	2.22		
HindustanUnicore	4861.10	-20.89	89.09	2.68		
Peddlers	222.00	-23.86	8.97	1.98		
Adani Power	212.63	-25.58	28.22	3.46		
Adani Hotels Co.	706.40	-30.88	43.55	2.43		
Adani Energy Solutions	1581.40	-36.38	61.47	2.04		
Tata Motors CV	463.90	-41.27	41.01	3.82		
Tvs Motor Corp	4304.20	-72.09	56.78	3.96		

Spycam specs

Smart glasses are offensive and should be banned

A legal notice to Meta and an Instagram user, issued by a man in Delhi, over a video allegedly recorded without his knowledge using Meta smart glasses should set off alarm bells in India. The incident points to the possibility of ordinary-looking spectacles becoming a tool for covert recording, humiliation, harassment and even sexual exploitation.



The risk is no longer just theory. Reports from Sweden reveal that contractors working for Meta’s data-annotation partner said they had seen recordings captured by the glasses in deeply private situations. Meta has said that the material remains on the device unless users share it with Meta or others, and that safeguards are used when shared material is reviewed. But the fact remains — and this is indefensible — that once a camera is embedded in something that looks like an ordinary pair of spectacles, the person being filmed may have no idea that a recording is taking place. Worse, the recording indicator is hardly an impenetrable safeguard. Reports have found that the LED can be tampered with.

Many countries are already taking the threat seriously. Texas has opened an investigation into Meta’s glasses over concerns including recordings, facial data and the effectiveness of the recording indicator. Germany has seen a criminal complaint filed against Meta and others over alleged covert filming; its regulator has also warned about the privacy risks of smart glasses. In Britain, courts have barred their use in courtrooms, while cinemas are restricting them. Sweden’s data-protection authority has separately issued guidance warning users about the ease of discreet filming. The argument for allowing the glasses is not particularly compelling anyway for the average consumer. Most of their headline features including taking photographs, listening to music, making calls, asking an AI assistant questions or translating text, are conveniences that smartphones and earbuds already provide. The privacy risk, however, is significant.

While a smartphone camera usually has to be pointed at someone, a pair of glasses can record while the wearer appears to be doing nothing at all. In the Indian context, monitoring millions of users and detecting covert recording is inherently difficult. By the time a victim discovers a recording, it may already have been uploaded and widely circulated. Worse, cheaper versions of smart glasses are flooding the Indian market, enabling easy proliferation. India’s Digital Personal Data Protection framework also remains under phased implementation, with key provisions not taking effect until 2027. Its headline penalties, up to ₹250 crore for some breaches, may not be substantial compared to the damage the glasses can do. There may be select uses that justify making the technology available. For the visually impaired, hands-free AI, visual descriptions and assistance can be genuinely transformative. If such benefits are demonstrated, policymakers could permit those applications with strict guardrails. But for everyone else, policymakers should move quickly to stop the sale of this device in the country.

OTHER VOICES.

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

You’re living longer, Americans

Pessimists on the political left and right can’t find much good to say about America these days, so allow us to help. American life expectancy hit a record in 2024 as deaths fell from most major causes, according to a Centers for Disease Control and Prevention report this week. Life expectancy at birth rose to 79 from 78.4 in 2023, surpassing the pre-pandemic high of 78.9 in 2014. The statistic reflects the average number of years newborns are expected to live if mortality trends stay constant over their lifespans. Changes in the statistic from year to year reflect changes in public health. (NEW YORK, AUGUST 27)

GULF NEWS

Meta’s \$18 billion wake-up call

Eighteen billion dollars. It’s a number that is hard to comprehend even when written down in various ways. That’s what Meta has agreed to pay to settle claims from 29 US states that it built Instagram and Facebook to hook children. While signing those cheques, the company isn’t admitting it did anything wrong. Corporate settlements rarely do; it’s the legal equivalent of paying for the neighbour’s very expensive window after insisting your football never went near it. But the company has agreed to daily time limits for teen accounts and a raft of product changes. Let’s put that huge pile of cash to one side (imagine how big those dollar bills would be stacked up) and focus on the tech bit, as it’s what will change the future for millions of people. It’s quite rare that a trillion-dollar company starts redesigning its algorithms because of 29 attorneys. This is an industry admitting, very expensively, that it built something that it is struggling to defend. (DUBAI, AUGUST 28)

CSR: Where does the money go?

LITTLE FOR NEEDY. Richer States and sectors like education where public provision is already strong get bulk of the funds



PAYAL SETH

In July 2026, a report delivered a triumphant headline: ‘India Inc’s corporate social responsibility (CSR) spending hit a record ₹40,794 crore in 2024-25, up 17 per cent on the year before’. More companies are giving than ever, and a larger share of the money is going straight into projects rather than into government funds. On the surface, a policy experiment is working. Yet a record number only measures how much was spent, not whom it reached. That is the question worth asking, since the fund now is large enough to matter.

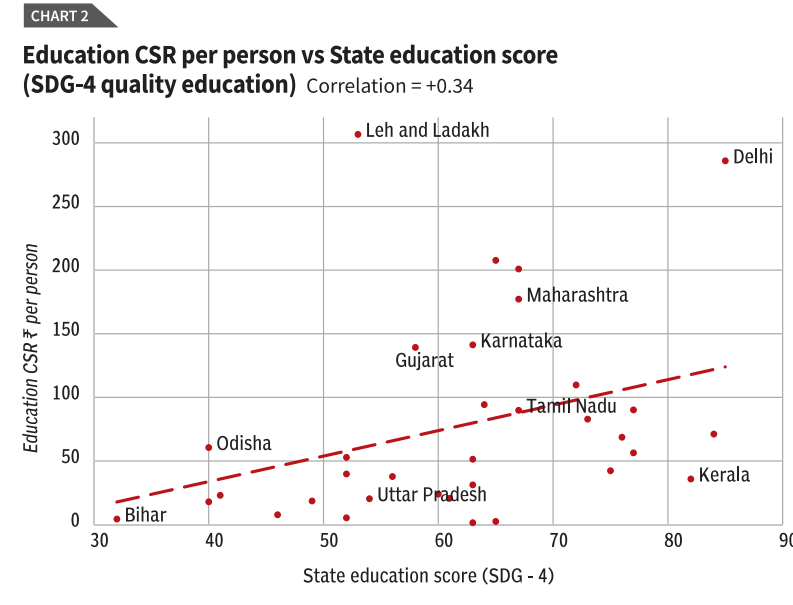
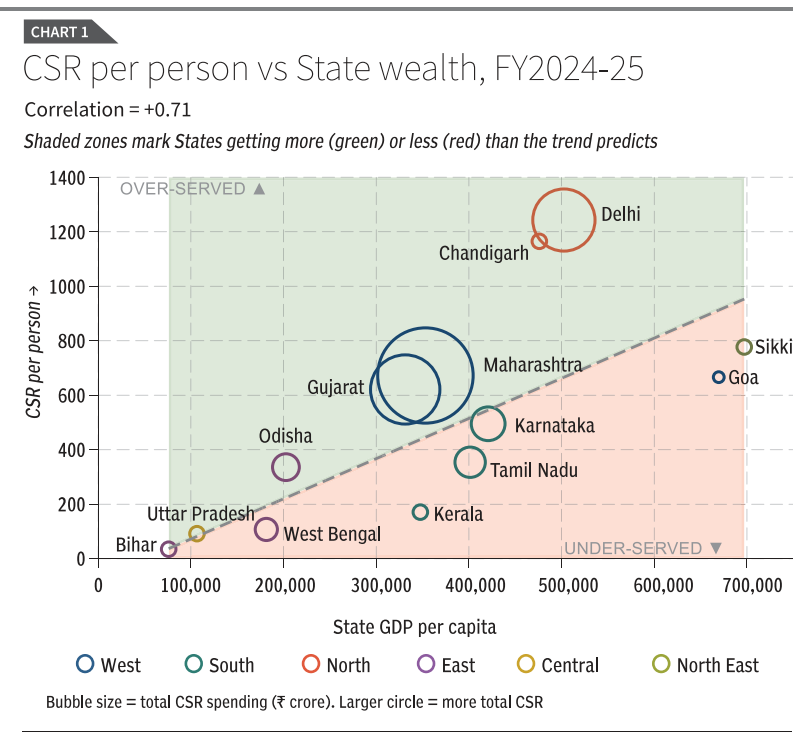
India is one of very few countries to make corporate charity a legal duty. Under Section 135 of the Companies Act, 2013, any company with a net worth of ₹500 crore or more, a turnover of ₹1,000 crore or more, or net profit of ₹5 crore or more must spend at least 2 per cent of its average net profit over the previous three years on approved social causes, from education and health to rural development and the environment.

Nearly 30,000 firms now spend under the rule. But no central plan directs the money. Each company picks its own causes, its own projects and, crucially, its own locations. Multiply those thousands of separate decisions across a decade and a pattern takes shape, and the pattern is not the one the law’s drafters might have hoped for.

The money follows income, not need. Chart 1 makes this plain. Each bubble is a State; its position from left to right shows income per person, and its height shows CSR received per person (Ministry of Corporate Affairs database). If giving followed need, the richer States on the right would receive less per head, and the bubbles would slope downward.

They do the opposite. The dashed line rising from bottom-left to top-right is the trend, and almost every large State sits along it. In 2024-25 the link between a State’s wealth and its CSR per person was strong, with a correlation of +0.71, and it has stayed strong for 11 years running.

The consequences are stark at the extremes. Delhi received roughly ₹1,243 per person and sits high in the “over-served” zone. Bihar, among the poorest States in the country, received about ₹35 a head, pinned to the bottom-left corner. Uttar Pradesh, at



₹92, and West Bengal, at ₹108, are not far above it. These are three of India’s largest and least prosperous populations, and they draw some of the thinnest support.

If we narrow the lens to a single

Education is no outlier. Together with health, it accounts for roughly 56 per cent of all CSR, and both causes lean towards the States already doing best.

sector, the same logic hardens. Education is the single biggest CSR cause, absorbing about 34 per cent of all spending in 2024-25. Chart 2 plots each State’s SDG-4 (quality education) score against how much education CSR it receives per person. Bihar has the weakest education outcomes in the country (SDG-4 (quality education) score of 32 — worst in India). In 2023-24, it received about ₹4 per person for education. Delhi, the top on outcomes (SDG-4 score of 85 — highest in the country), got about ₹286, seventy times more. And education is no outlier. Together

What’s wrong in using AI to write articles, asks ChatGPT

The test is whether the article is true, useful and interesting. That, ultimately, is what newspapers should care about, says the LLM

The Wall Street Journal recently published an oped article written by a regular contributor using AI. That set off a global debate on whether opinion-makers should use Artificial Intelligence (AI) to write articles. Our columnist TCA Srinivasa Raghavan asked ChatGPT to weigh in on the matter in the form of a 650 word article, written in his style. Here’s the output:

There is a curious new anxiety doing the rounds in newspaper offices: that artificial intelligence might write articles. This is apparently a bad thing. I have never quite understood why.

Newspapers have spent decades getting machines to do almost everything except write the article. They use computers to receive copy, edit it, transmit it, lay it out, print it and distribute it. They use software to count words, check spelling, track readership and tell editors which stories people are reading. But the moment somebody suggests that a machine might help write the words, journalists suddenly discover the sanctity of human creativity.

This is rather like railway employees objecting to electric trains because steam locomotives have souls.

The first objection is that AI cannot write as well as a good journalist.

Quite right. Neither can most journalists. The second is that AI will eventually replace journalists. Possibly.

But that is not an argument against using it. It is an argument for becoming better at journalism. At least in principle.

There is an important distinction here: between reporting and writing.

Reporting is what makes journalism journalism. Finding something out, persuading somebody to talk, discovering the document nobody else has seen, noticing that two apparently unrelated facts are related, understanding the significance of a number and asking the question everybody else was too lazy to ask — these are human activities.

Writing the resulting 600 words is not necessarily one of them.

So why should the first draft of an article be sacred? It isn’t.

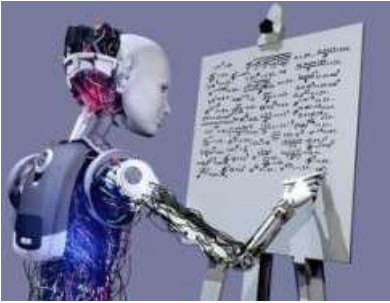
What matters is whether the article is true, useful and interesting.

EDITING MATTERS

This is where the argument against AI becomes particularly odd. Nobody seriously proposes that journalists should publish whatever they write without editing. Every decent newspaper has layers of checking between the reporter and the reader.

The answer to all these problems is the same: editing.

The real danger is not that AI will write newspaper stories. The real danger



AI. Can produce routine stuff quickly

is that newspapers will use AI badly.

Consider a reporter receiving a 400-page government report. Somebody has to read it, search it, extract the tables, compare them with last year’s numbers and identify what has changed.

AI can do much of that donkey work in minutes. That does not mean the machine has written the story. It means the journalist has been given something journalists desperately need: time.

A good reporter should spend less time copying numbers from page 137 of a PDF and more time asking why those numbers have changed.

AI can produce the routine stuff quickly and consistently. That leaves human beings to do the difficult stuff.

Of course there is a catch. Editors will have to edit. This sounds obvious, but nobody seems to have thought it

with health, it accounts for roughly 56 per cent of all CSR, and both causes lean towards the States already doing best. When corporate money piles up where public provision is already strongest, it widens the gaps it was meant to close.

The cause is not corporate indifference. Every firm’s logic is sound on its own terms: they spend near their plants and offices, invest in the communities they draw workers and goodwill from, and back the causes they know how to run. Since industry concentrates in the richer States, so does the money. The distortion is not the work of any villain; it is the aggregate of thousands of individually reasonable decisions, none of which was ever asked to consider the national map.

That is exactly why this is a question of design rather than conscience. And the concentration is a habit, not a hard limit. When the pandemic struck, CSR pivoted within weeks, pouring into health and relief through 2020-21. Once the emergency eased, giving settled back into its familiar grooves. Corporate India can plainly move money to acute need when it chooses to. Left alone, its choices simply point elsewhere.

HOW TO FIX IT

The remedy need not be heavy-handed, and it should not be. India already has the scaffolding. NITI Aayog’s aspirational-districts programme maps the country’s most under-served pockets with hard data. The most direct nudge would be to match private rupees spent in those districts with public ones, so that a company’s giving stretches furthest where it is scarcest.

Gentler tools point the same way: recognition for firms that invest in the hardest places, or lighter compliance for money that reaches the bottom of the development ladder.

None of this dictates where a company must spend. It rewards the choice the mandate was always meant to encourage. Sharper disclosure would help too, since today we can see where the money goes but almost nothing about what it achieves.

The architects of Section 135 got the hard part right. They built a large, durable stream of development finance and made corporate India a genuine partner in it. The unfinished task is the one this year’s headline glides past: not how much is given, but where. A decade in, the fair question for policymakers and boardrooms alike is whether we are willing to send the money somewhere harder.

The writer is Lead Economist and Head of Center of Data for Economic Decision-making (CoDED) at Pahlé India Foundation



QUICKLY.

Alpha Wave Global sells 1.7% stake in Lenskart



New Delhi: Global alternative asset firm Alpha Wave Global divested a 1.7 per cent stake in eyewear retailer Lenskart Solutions for ₹1,856 crore through open market transactions. New York-based Alpha Wave Global, through its three affiliates, offloaded a total of 2,94,72,670 shares, representing a 1.69 per cent stake in Lenskart. The shares were sold at an average price of ₹630 apiece, taking the combined transaction value to ₹1,856.78 crore. At the end of the June quarter, Alpha Wave Global, through its affiliates, owned a combined 4.64 per cent equity stake in Lenskart. On the other side of the trade were a mix of domestic and foreign institutional investors who picked up shares at the same price. **PM**

Govt eases defence export rules to boost reach of indigenous weapons

TAKING THE LEAD. Stakeholder consultation dispensed with for the export of non-lethal defence items

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Unlocking policy barriers hindering the global reach of indigenous weapon systems, the Ministry of Defence (MoD) has simplified its defence export standard operating procedure (SOP) and open general export licence (OGEL) framework to ease compliance burdens and accelerate access to global markets.

RECORD PRODUCTION
These reforms are expected to further strengthen the momentum of India's defence manufacturing and export ecosystem, with defence production reaching an all-time high of ₹1.78 lakh crore and defence exports touching record ₹38,424 crore in FY26. India exports weapons

systems and platforms such as BrahMos supersonic cruise missiles, Akash-1S surface-to-air missile, Pinaka multi-barrel rocket launchers, ATAGS 155mm howitzers and artillery shells, patrol vessels, light-weight torpedoes and armoured vehicles to around 100 countries, including to the US, France, Israel, Armenia, Philippines and Italy.

Under the new defence export standard operating procedure, stakeholder consultation has been dispensed with for the export of non-lethal defence items to most destinations, while appropriate safeguards have been retained for sensitive countries, said the Minister in a statement on Friday. Ahead of the announcement, Sanjeev Kumar, Secretary, Department of Defence Production, had said at an Assocham event on Tues-



MAKING PROGRESS. At present, India exports weapons systems and platforms to around 100 countries

day that the export licensing regime is being rationalised, with him delegating powers to a Joint Secretary in his department, and a one-time, multi-year export authorisation regime under consideration for long-term supply partners of global OEMs. The revised open general

Ministry's statement read. It provides greater flexibility while reducing repetitive procedural requirements.

UNIFIED OGEL SOP
The MoD also stated that three existing OGEL SOPs covering major platforms and equipment, parts and components and intra-company transfer of technology, have been merged into one unified OGEL SOP, providing exporters with a common and simpler framework. The OGEL validity has been increased from two to three years, reducing the frequency of renewals and associated compliance requirements. Moreover, the OGEL coverage has been expanded from 41 to all countries, "except negative/sensitive nations and those facing UN Security Council sanctions or arms embargoes".

New technologies like AI will create more jobs: Radhakrishnan

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Vice-President CP Radhakrishnan said on Friday that new technologies such as artificial intelligence (AI) will enhance ease of doing work and help create more jobs.

'NOT A THREAT'
Speaking at the launch of Gnani Artha, an end-to-end sovereign AI stack for Indian enterprises and public institutions, he said concerns over job losses were raised when computers were introduced in the country, but the IT industry had turned out to

be the biggest job creator not only within the country but even overseas. He said even highly qualified people were raising concerns about a reduction in jobs due to the induction of AI in their fields. "The more technology comes in, the more ease of work will come. That will create more jobs. Bharat has undergone significant transformation in almost every sector, including in AI, in the past 12 years," said Radhakrishnan. He also noted that reverse migration has started taking place now, and people are coming back to the country, bringing new technologies



(from left) Ganesh Gopalan, CEO & Co-founder, Gnani.ai; Vice-President of India CP Radhakrishnan; and Ananth Nagaraj, Co-founder & CTO, Gnani.ai, at the launch of Gnani Artha

that they learnt over the years. For instance, Digital Sansad had started using AI to translate parliamentary debates and papers available

in multiple Indian languages, he said, adding that AI had tremendous scope. Talking about Gnani Artha, he said it is a part of a

larger national journey towards self-reliance. "May this initiative contribute to building a stronger, more self-reliant and technologically empowered India. That is my wish," he added.

GNANI EVON V3.3
Developed by Gnani.ai, Gnani Artha is backed by the government's India AI Mission to develop sovereign AI technology. Radhakrishnan unveiled Gnani Evon v3.3, a 30-billion-parameter open-weights model trained natively across 11 Indian languages — and Gnani Plexus, the company's agentic AI platform. "We are offering Indic lan-

guage capability at the lowest possible cost. The terminology that we used was Indic language capability on a cost-per-compute basis. That is where we score much better than any other model in the market. Our models consume 40 per cent less tokens; indirectly it's a 40 per cent cost-saving for these companies," said Ganesh Gopalan, Co-founder and CEO, Gnani.ai. The reasoning model Gnani Evon v3.3 is an open source model, which already started seeing traction from enterprise clients in banking, finance and insurance sectors, as well as retail segment players, Gopalan added.

Fino Payments Bank 'on track to meet RBI conditions to convert to small finance bank'

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Fino Payments Bank Ltd (FPBL) is advancing well and remains on track to meet the RBI-stipulated conditions for transition to a small finance bank (SFB), according to Interim CEO Ketan Merchant.

"We continue to expect that all required milestones will be completed within the prescribed 18-month timeline, and we remain on course to submit our readiness to the Reserve Bank of India by the end of Q4 FY27," he said.

The RBI, on December 5, 2025, granted in-principle approval to FPBL for conversion to an SFB. According to RBI guidelines for on-tap licensing of SFBs in the private sector, existing payments banks, which are con-



Ketan Merchant, Interim CEO, Fino Payments Bank

trolled by residents and have completed five years of operations, are eligible for conversion to SFBs. "We have appointed Price-waterhouseCoopers to support the implementation and overall operational readiness of SFB. We have also on-boarded technology partners for our loan origination system, loan management system and other lending applications that will form the

backbone of our lending platform," said Merchant in a recent analyst call. Alongside this, the bank continues to strengthen its governance framework by putting in place the required policies, operating procedures and compliance process to support SFB.

TECHNOLOGY STACK
In parallel, technology stack for the end-to-end customer loan journey is under development, and is expected to be ready by February 2027. "Our focus is on retail segment, customer acquisition and referral lending, and we are taking right strides and at a steady pace in each of these. This is a conscious strategy in light of our small finance bank transition. Our capital position continues to remain comfortably above the regulatory requirement

for the proposed SFB," said Merchant. FPBL's Interim CEO emphasised that the bank's objective remains to build a differentiated SFB anchored on three enduring competitive strengths. "The first is strong liability franchise that gives the bank structural advantage in terms of cost of funds. Second is predominantly secured and asset-light lending model powered by huge network covering more than 95 per cent of India's pin code, enabling efficient customer acquisition, disciplined underwriting and scalable growth. And third is technology-led operation platform built around Finacle, AI-enabled lending capabilities and robust digital infrastructure that will support innovation and operational efficiency," he added.

40% fall in ADAS hardware cost brings safety tech closer to mass-market cars

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

Level 2 advanced driver-assistance systems (ADAS) features such as automatic emergency braking, adaptive cruise control, lane-keeping assistance and blind-spot warning, which require the driver to remain attentive and in control, have trickled down from ₹30 lakh-plus vehicles to upper variants of Honda Amaze compact sedan priced at around ₹9.39 lakh and Mahindra XUV 3XO sub-four-metre compact SUV priced at ₹11.99 lakh.

Hanif Qureshi, Additional Secretary in the Ministry of Heavy Industries, said the changing economics could broaden access to automotive safety technology. "Hardware costs are dropping, solid-state LiDAR units moving below \$400 and camera modules falling under \$20. This means safety features once reserved for luxury vehicles are now available across mass-market segments," said Qureshi.

CHEAPER HARDWARE
Over the past year, solid-state LiDAR prices have fallen 40-45 per cent to \$350-400 from \$600-800, short-range radar 35-40 per cent to \$16-20 from \$28-35 and HD camera modules 35-40 per cent to \$12-18 from \$22-30. High-compute ADAS controllers have become about 30 per cent cheaper at \$250-350, down from \$450-600. The decline is part of a longer technology-cost reset. Early mechanical LiDAR

units could cost roughly \$5,000-10,000 or more in 2019-20, compared with about \$350-400 for newer solid-state units today, though the technologies aren't strictly comparable. Lower costs give automakers more room to offer active-safety technology on high-volume models, while buyers could get ADAS without paying for the most expensive trims. Component suppliers could benefit, too: falling unit prices can be offset by increasing camera, radar, electronics and software content per vehicle.

ANOTHER INCENTIVE
Bharat NCAP adds another incentive. As active-safety technologies assume a greater role in India's vehicle-safety assessment, cheaper sensors and computing could lower the cost of equipping high-volume models, with functions such as AEB, and help manufac-

turers pursue stronger safety scores. Cost, however, is only one part of the problem. "Most people think autonomous driving starts with AI models, but AI is useless if a car cannot accurately perceive reality. No single sensor is enough for ADAS," said Qureshi. Each sensor has different strengths and weaknesses. Cameras recognise lanes, signs and objects, but can be affected by glare; radar measures distance and relative speed, but offers less visual detail; LiDAR builds a three-dimensional picture, but can degrade in dense fog; and ultrasonic sensors cover close-range manoeuvres. "Ultimately, the race towards autonomy won't be won by the car with the flashiest AI model, but by the system that masters the seamless fusion of hardware, perception and perhaps the most important — human trust," said Qureshi.

AEPC urges Commerce Minister to take measures to regulate cotton yarn export

Our Bureau
Chennai

The Apparel Export Promotion Council (AEPC) has urged Union Minister of Commerce and Industry Piyush Goyal to consider taking suitable measures to regulate the export of cotton yarn, particularly of 20s count and above. This is due to the sharp increase in yarn prices and the growing pressure on the competitiveness of India's apparel export industry. Cotton yarn prices have increased by around 60 per cent, from approximately ₹250 per kg in early 2026, to around ₹400 per kg now, further increasing pressure on the apparel manufacturing value chain. Rising costs of other raw materials and fuel are also aggravating the situation, said AEPC Chairman A



Sakthivel in a letter to the Minister. The council also sought the intervention and support of Union Minister of Textiles Giriraj Singh. It highlighted that a substantial quantity of cotton had moved from farmers to traders, contributing to hoarding and speculative practices in the market.

US RESTRICTIONS
Sakthivel also highlighted the increase in exports of Indian cotton and cotton yarn

Army to procure 100 Javelin missiles worth \$93 m from the US

Dalip Singh
New Delhi

The Army has signed a US foreign military sales letter of offer and acceptance (LoA) to procure nearly 100 FGM-148 Javelin anti-tank guided missile systems worth \$93 million.

The move comes after an approval was granted by the US State Department in November last year. Through the emergency procurement route, the Army will acquire nearly 100 Javelin missiles, one fly-to-buy round, 25 command-launch units, training aids, simulation rounds, spare parts and full lifecycle support.

US Ambassador Sergio Gor announced on Friday that India plans to buy the battle-tested Javelin anti-tank system. "Just as @secwar (Secretary, War, Pete Hegseth) highlighted at the May 2026 Shangri-La Dialogue, this is a great step forward in the US-India defence relationship and opens the door to co-production possibilities," Gor wrote on X, adding that the engagement between our two nations is at "record high levels". The US embassy in a statement on Friday, too, said that the agreement opens discussions on "mutually beneficial co-production" of Javelin — manufactured by the Javelin Joint Venture, a partnership between RTX and Lockheed Martin — and additional opportunities to strengthen the defence industrial bases of both countries.

DRDO WEAPON
The acquisition decision comes at a time when DRDO's similar shoulder-fired anti-tank weapon, the

The missiles are designed for use against a wide array of targets, including armoured vehicles and fortified positions

man-portable anti-tank guided missile (MPATGM), is undergoing final user evaluation trial before mass production. The MPATGM is a third generation fire-and-forget missile. With the signing of the LoA, the US Embassy stated that India has become a customer of the Javelin system, an advanced, medium-range, anti-tank guided missile used by the their army, US Marine Corps and numerous international customers. It's designed for use against a wide array of targets, including armoured vehicles and fortified positions. The embassy said that the landmark signature further strengthens the US-India Major Defence Partnership by demonstrating the depth of ongoing US support to the Indian Army. This is one among the list of defence procurements the Trump administration has been advocating for long.

MORE IN THE LINE
According to a notification issued by the US Defence Security Cooperation Agency in November 2025, India also requested up to 216 M982A1 Excalibur tactical projectiles with an estimated cost of \$47.1 million. The Excalibur is a GPS-guided, extended-range artillery round known for its high precision. It was used by the Army during Operation Sindoor to target Pakistani installations.

COCHIN INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT LIMITED
(CIN: L1100G11996PLC028980)
Registered Office: 'HOEC House', Tandallai Road, Vadodara - 390 020, Gujarat, India
Chennai Office: 'Lakshmi Chambers', 192, St. Mary's Road, Alwarpet, Chennai - 600 018, Tamil Nadu, India. Phone: 044-66229000, Fax: 044-66229011/12
E-mail: hoecshare@hoec.com, Website: www.hoec.com

CIAL/COMM/SHW/76 TENDER NOTICE 29.08.2026
Online Item Rate E-tenders are invited from reputed agencies for the work mentioned below at Cochin International Airport.

Sl.No	Name of Work	Estimate Amount	EMD	Completion Period
1	SITC of Hyper-Converged Infrastructure Solution at CIAL	Rs. 35 Crores Inclusive of taxes	Rs.20 Lakh	6 Months

Interested firms may register themselves on the online E-Tendering portal <https://etenders.kerala.gov.in> and then download the Tender documents. For eligibility criteria and other details, visit our website www.cial.aero.
Sd/-
Managing Director

HINDUSTAN OIL EXPLORATION COMPANY LIMITED
(CIN: L1100G11996PLC028980)
Registered Office: 'HOEC House', Tandallai Road, Vadodara - 390 020, Gujarat, India
Chennai Office: 'Lakshmi Chambers', 192, St. Mary's Road, Alwarpet, Chennai - 600 018, Tamil Nadu, India. Phone: 044-66229000, Fax: 044-66229011/12
E-mail: hoecshare@hoec.com, Website: www.hoec.com

42ND ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING OF THE COMPANY
Members are requested to note that the 42nd Annual General Meeting (AGM) of the Company will be held on Friday, the 25th day of September 2026 at 11.00 a.m. through Video Conferencing (VC) / Other Audio-Visual Means (OAVM), in compliance with the Circulars issued by the Ministry of Corporate Affairs (MCA) the latest being General Circular No. 03/2025 dated 22/09/2025 and SEBI Circular No. SEBI/HO/CFD/CFD-PoD-2/P/CIR/2024/133 dated October 3, 2024 issued by SEBI (hereinafter collectively referred to as "the Circulars") and all other applicable laws, to transact the businesses that will be set forth in the Notice of the 42nd AGM.
In compliance with the above Circulars, the Notice of the AGM along with the Annual Report of FY 2025-26 will be sent only through electronic mode to those Members whose e-mail IDs are registered with the Company / Depository Participants.
A letter providing the web-link and exact path where complete details of Annual Report of FY 2025-26 is available will be sent to Members who have not registered their e-mail IDs.
Members may note that the Notice and Annual Report of FY 2025-26 will also be made available on the Company's website www.hoec.com, websites of the Stock Exchanges i.e. BSE Limited and National Stock Exchange of India Limited at www.bseindia.com and www.nseindia.com respectively, and on the website of CDSL www.evotingindia.com.
Members who have not registered their e-mail addresses so far are requested to register the same in respect of shares held in dematerialized form with the Depository through their Depository Participants (DP) and in respect of shares held in physical form by writing to the Registrar & Share Transfer Agent (RTA) - MUFG Intime India Private Limited (formerly known as Link Intime India Private Limited), "Geetakunj", 1, Bhakti Nagar Society, Behind ABS Tower, Old Padra Road, Vadodra, Gujarat 390015; Email id: vadodara@in.mpmis.mufg.com or by submitting the KYC forms at <https://web.in.mpmis.mufg.com/KYC-downloads.html>
The Company will provide the facility to its Members to exercise their right to vote by electronic means, both through remote e-voting and e-voting at the AGM. The detailed instructions on the process of e-voting will be provided as part of the Notice of the 42nd AGM.
By order of the Board of Directors
For **HINDUSTAN OIL EXPLORATION COMPANY LIMITED**
Sd/-
G. Josephin Daisy
Company Secretary

Place : Chennai
Date : August 29, 2026

QUICKLY.

Task force formed to review exam reforms

New Delhi A high-powered task force, set up by the Centre amid the recent protests by student bodies over paper leak allegations at Jantar Mantar, on Friday invited public suggestions on comprehensive reforms in public examinations, including measures to fix accountability and strengthen institutional arrangements. The Centre in July announced the constitution of the six-member high-powered task force (HPTF) chaired by Infosys Co-founder Nandan Nilekani to recommend reforms related to the security, design and governance of public exam. **PTI**

Govt appoints 2 Directors, Joint Director to NTA

New Delhi: The Centre has appointed IPS officer Ravi Kumar Singh and Prasanna Venkatesh V, an IAS officer, as Directors and IRS officer Amit Samdariya as Joint Director to the National Testing Agency (NTA), according to the Personnel Ministry. The agency has been drawing flak for issues related to the National Eligibility-cum-Entrance Test paper leak, among other concerns. **PTI**

Govt forms mediation council after panel nudge

New Delhi: Nearly three years after the law was enacted, the government has set up the Mediation Council of India to regulate mediation proceedings in the country after a nudge from a parliamentary committee. A Union Law Ministry notification issued on Thursday night announced the start of the council under the Mediation Act, 2023. It will regulate and promote institutional dispute resolution and will recognise mediation service providers and institutes that train and certify professionals. **PTI**

CII panel moots creation of green finance institution to mobilise funds

INDUSTRIAL TRANSITION. It will support renewables, storage, clean transport and hydrogen projects

Our Bureau
New Delhi

India should set up a dedicated Green Finance Institution (GFI) to mobilise capital at scale for green infrastructure and industrial transition, alongside measures to make the country's carbon market more predictable as well as to strengthen corporate sustainability disclosures, a corporate panel on sustainability has proposed.

According to the India Sustainability Taskforce, constituted by the Confederation of Indian Industry (CII), the GFI should operate as an impact-oriented blended-finance platform rather than a conventional public-sector lender.

RECOMMENDATIONS
In its key recommendations, the taskforce said that the GFI should structure transactions, provide credit guarantees and other risk-sharing instruments, anchor funds and crowd in domestic and global private investment



CATALYSE FUNDS. The taskforce said that the GFI should structure transactions, provide guarantees, anchor funds and crowd in domestic and global private investment for climate projects

into climate-aligned projects.

The proposed institution would focus particularly on mid-sized companies and MSMEs, which often face higher costs of capital and weaker access to finance.

As per the recommendations, green credit for these segments should primarily flow through banks and NBFCs using standardised taxonomy-aligned products, supported by partial credit guarantees or first-loss cover from the GFI.

DRIVING INVESTMENTS
The taskforce has set an in-

dicative figure for the GFI to catalyse up to \$1 trillion of investment over five to 10 years, subject to its institutional design, capitalisation and project pipeline.

Accordingly, the institution could support renewable energy, energy storage, clean transportation, industrial decarbonisation, green hydrogen, offshore wind and MSME supply-chain transition, among other areas.

Besides, the taskforce has proposed a legally authorised mechanism for public carbon-related revenue.

Furthermore, it said that where the government es-

tablishes a specifically designated GFI-linked mechanism, it has recommended allocating 100 per cent of the net legally appropriable proceeds to the GFI, while keeping such public revenue separate from the value generated through private carbon-credit trading.

CARBON MARKETS
On carbon markets, the taskforce has recommended retaining the existing emissions-intensity baseline-and-credit architecture, while progressively tightening sectoral targets. It has called for publica-

Govt expects 25,000 registrations under Parivartan scheme by October

Press Trust of India
New Delhi

The Ministry of Road Transport and Highways expects 25,000 beneficiary registrations under the Parivartan (Programme for Accelerated Renewal and Incentivisation of Vehicle Assets for Reducing Transport Air Pollution and Network Emissions) scheme.

It was launched last

month to phase out polluting commercial vehicles in Delhi-NCR.

As many as 1,450 old truck and bus owners have so far registered under the scheme since its launch on July 14, Road Transport and Highways Secretary V Umashankar said on Friday.

Addressing a press conference, Umashankar said the Ministry expects more than 25,000 old commercial truck and bus owners to register

under the Parivartan scheme by October.

There are over 2 lakh trucks and buses conforming to Bharat Stage (BS)-IV or prior emission norms, registered in the National Capital Territory of Delhi, according to the Ministry.

The scheme was approved by the Union Cabinet on June 3 with a total outlay of ₹9,585 crore, including ₹5,041 crore as Central government support.

The Ministry of Road Transport and Highways (MoRTH) is implementing the scheme through the National Capital Region Planning Board (NCRPB).

MULTIPLE INCENTIVES
The beneficiaries will receive multiple incentives, including motor vehicle tax concessions, registration fee waivers, 5 per cent interest subvention on vehicle loans, a minimum 8 per cent dis-

count from original equipment manufacturers (OEMs), monthly fuel voucher support for eligible diesel and CNG replacement vehicles, and one-time financial assistance for electric replacement vehicles and Certificate of Deposit (CoD) trading.

The governments of Rajasthan, Haryana, Uttar Pradesh and Delhi have notified a 10-year motor vehicle tax concession and registration

fee waiver for eligible new vehicles under the scheme.

As many as 15 OEMs, accounting for over 95 per cent of the commercial vehicle market, have signed agreements with MoRTH to provide the mandated discounts for replacement of old commercial vehicles. For buyers opting for BS-VI diesel or CNG vehicles, the scheme provides monthly fuel vouchers ranging from ₹1,200 to ₹4,800 for five

years, depending on the vehicle category.

SCHEME DETAILS
The Parivartan scheme aims to reduce vehicular pollution in Delhi-NCR. The scheme will be implemented through an integrated digital platform linked with VAHAN, V-Scrap, DigiELV, PFMS, participating lenders and fuel voucher systems to ensure transparent and seamless delivery of benefits.

AM Intelligence to launch 30 MW AI infra centre by April 2027 in Hyderabad

KV Kurmanath
Hyderabad

AM Intelligence, an AI infrastructure company backed by Greenko's promoters, will set up a 30 MW artificial intelligence compute facility in Hyderabad by March-April 2027 as the first step in its plan to build 1 GW of compute-as-a-service (CaaS) AI infrastructure.

GPU CLUSTERS

Under the CaaS model, foundation model developers and enterprises can contract dedicated GPU clusters for one to five years for training and inference.

The company plans to develop a total data centre capacity of 5 GW.

The 30 MW deployment will be part of the first phase of the project, in which the firm will build 200 MW of AI compute infrastructure with



Anil Chalamalasetty (left), Group Chairman, AM Group, and Mahesh Kolli, Group President

an investment of \$8 billion over the next 18 months.

"We have placed the order for 9,000 Nvidia Vera Rubin GPUs for the first 30 MW in Hyderabad. The racks should start arriving in January, and we expect the facility to be fully operational by March or April 2027," Mahesh Kolli of AM Intelligence told *businessline*.

CAPACITY ADDITIONS

The Hyderabad facility will be followed by capacity additions in India, Malaysia, Finland and the US as the company scales up its AI compute operations to 200 MW over the next 18 months.

The 200 MW rollout forms part of its longer-term plan to build 1 GW of CaaS capa-

city. "Of the proposed 5 GW data centre portfolio, we plan to retain about 1 GW for our own CaaS operations. The remaining capacity can be offered to hyperscalers, AI cloud companies and other global operators," Kolli said.

The larger 5 GW programme will span locations in India and overseas, with Noida, Visakhapatnam and Maharashtra among the locations being considered in India, as well as Finland and the US.

GROWING CONCERNS

Asked about growing concerns over the power and water requirements of large data centres, Kolli said newer AI infrastructure would have a substantially different cooling profile.

Vera Rubin-based systems rely predominantly on liquid cooling, reducing the requirement for large volumes of water.

TN begins discussions with stakeholders on upgradation and expansion of Chennai airport

T E Raja Simhan
Chennai

The Tamil Nadu government on Friday held a meeting with various stakeholders to improve the performance and capacity of the Chennai airport and set the ball rolling for the proposed Terminal 5.

This comes after the State dropped the ₹27,400 crore greenfield airport project at Parandur.

MAIN DISCUSSION

The TN Industries Department on Friday held a meeting with stakeholders, including officials from the airport, airlines and industry associations, to discuss measures to improve the existing airport and strengthen infrastructure. The meeting focused on the proposed Terminal 5 expansion on the western side of the airport.

"The main discussion was



PROJECT DEADLINE. The government has sought a clear deadline and construction schedule for completing Terminal 3 and commissioning the T3 plaza

the new elevated approach road from the proposed new terminal (T5) to the Chennai bypass road, operational performance and capacity enhancement of Chennai airport, and recommendations

to enhance user experience at Chennai airport," Industries Secretary S Vijayakumar told *businessline*. For Terminal 5, the discussions covered its design, a flood study and preparation of a

comprehensive development plan. Airport sources said a no-objection certificate from the Water Resources Department would be required for constructing the elevated corridor along the Adyar river bund.

The government has sought a clear deadline and construction schedule for completing Terminal 3 and commissioning the T3 plaza. The Airports Authority of India has been asked to expedite the work, said Vijaykumar. On airport operations and capacity enhancement, the government decided to conduct monthly reviews to monitor progress.

Improving passenger experience is another key focus. The government plans to examine areas such as food and beverage services, lounges, and the entry and exit experience. A consultant has been asked to review these aspects and make recommendations.

TN to expedite MRTS plans for 5 cities, submits DPRs for CMRL extension

Our Bureau
Chennai

The Tamil Nadu government has undertaken detailed feasibility studies for Mass Rapid Transit Systems in Coimbatore, Madurai, Salem, Tiruchirappalli and Tirunelveli in view of the rising traffic congestion and travel demand.

DPRs SUBMITTED

For Coimbatore and Madurai, CMRL has submitted DPRs and the proposals were recommended to the Centre for funding under a 50:50 equity-sharing arrangement.

However, the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs returned these, stating that it had no objection to implementing an at-grade or elevated Bus Rapid Transit System in the two cities, the



A revised DPR has to be submitted for the extension of Metro Rail to the mofussil bus terminus at Kilambakkam

policy note said. Tirunelveli did not qualify for implementation of a suitable MRTS, while the detailed feasibility report for Salem is under consideration.

CMRL EXTENSION

For Tiruchirappalli, further action has been deferred due

to the substantial committed liabilities associated with the ongoing Chennai Metro Phase-II project, according to the Special Initiatives Department Policy Note 2026-27 tabled in the Assembly on Friday.

The CMRL has submitted DPRs for extending Corridor-4 from Poonamallee Bypass to Sunguvarchatram via Sriperumbudur and for providing connectivity from Koyambedu to Pattabiram up to the Outer Ring Road via Ambattur and Avadi.

On the extension of the Metro Rail from Chennai airport to the mofussil bus terminus at Kilambakkam, the policy note said a revised DPR had to be submitted as the Highways Department had proposed an elevated road along the same corridor.

Approval from the Centre is awaited, it said.

Radisson to set up ₹100 cr five-star hotel in Ongole, AP

Our Bureau
Hyderabad

Andhra Pradesh Minister for IT Nara Lokesh on Friday laid the foundation for Radisson's five-star hotel in Chadalawada village, near Ongole, to be built on an investment of ₹100 crore.

JOINT PARTNERSHIP

The hotel is being developed through a joint partnership between the Ravishankar Group and Ravipriya Hospitality LLP and will be the first five-star hotel in the Ongole region.

The upcoming hotel will feature 151 luxury rooms, a multi-cuisine restaurant, a premium bar and lounge. Other facilities will include an international-standard swimming pool, a luxury spa and a modern fitness centre. The project will cater to

corporate meetings, conferences, government programmes, weddings and other large events.

More than 2,100 sq m of space will be dedicated to large banquet halls and conference rooms, providing a major boost to MICE (meetings, incentives, conferences and exhibitions) and business tourism in the Ongole region.

Located close to NH-16, the Chennai-Kolkata National Highway, the hotel is expected to offer convenient access to industrialists, business representatives and tourists.

RAPID DEVELOPMENT

With Ongole witnessing rapid development, the project is expected to contribute significantly to the growth of the local economy, according to a release.

Karnataka Minister resigns, blames BJP and JD(S)

Press Trust of India
Bengaluru



B Nagendra, Planning and Statistics Minister

Karnataka Planning and Statistics Minister B Nagendra on Friday announced his resignation from the Cabinet, 25 days after being re-inducted, amid allegations linked to the Valmiki Corporation scam.

His announcement came shortly after he said he would meet Chief Minister DK Shivakumar and announce his decision at a press conference.

"Today, I am voluntarily tendering my resignation as the minister," an emotional Nagendra told reporters. He said he had submitted his resignation to Shivakumar.

The Opposition BJP and the JD(S) had been protesting against his re-induction into the Cabinet, two years after he resigned over the same issue. They alleged his involvement in the ₹89 crore Karnataka Maharshi Valmiki Scheduled Tribes Development Corporation scam.

EPIC REFERENCE

Announcing his resignation in a choked voice, Nagendra compared the BJP's targeting of him to Lord Rama's killing of Shambuka in the Ramayana and alleged that the *manuwadis*, apparently

referring to the saffron party, never wanted a tribal person to rise.

Shambuka was an ascetic in the Uttara Kanda of the Valmiki Ramayana who, according to the text, was killed by Rama for performing penance.

Nagendra said he did not want to embarrass his party or allow the conspiracies of "manuwadis" and vile communal forces" to gain an upper hand in State politics.

The BJP's agitation in both Houses of the Karnataka Legislature had led to the abrupt adjournment of the Monsoon Session *sine die* on August 24, three days ahead of its scheduled conclusion.

The Opposition had planned a march from Raichur to Ballari from September 1 to 10.

TO ADVERTISE
PLEASE CONTACT

Chennai : 044 - 28576300

Coimbatore : 0422 - 2212572

Madurai : 0452 - 2528497

Trichy : 0431 - 2302801

Puducherry : 0413 - 2224111

thehindu **businessline.**

QUICKLY.

BioNTech to terminate mRNA cancer vaccine trial



BioNTech SE said on Friday it has decided to terminate the mid-stage trial of its experimental mRNA-based cancer vaccine. The trial was evaluating it as an adjuvant monotherapy in patients with high-risk stage II or stage III colorectal cancer whose tumours had been surgically removed but remained ctDNA-positive. REUTERS

Google changes policy in EU to avert antitrust fine

Alphabet's Google on Friday said it had changed its spam policy in Europe to address EU concerns that could have resulted in an antitrust fine. The US tech giant found itself in EU regulators' crosshairs after publishers complained about its site reputation abuse policy. REUTERS

Advent, Stripe likely to drop out of PayPal buyout

A consortium of buyout firm Advent and payment processor Stripe has decided to abandon its pursuit of fintech pioneer PayPal, Bloomberg News reported on Thursday. The payments company received a \$60.50-per-share bid from Stripe and private equity firm Advent International, which valued it at more than \$53 billion in July. The offer is a fraction of the roughly \$360 billion valuation PayPal commanded in 2021. PayPal's board saw the bid as inadequate and said it faced regulatory and financing hurdles. REUTERS

Nepal floods: 21 Indians arrive but 320 still remain ‘uncontactable’

HELPING HAND. India is ready to extend all possible assistance to Kathmandu in its rescue efforts: MEA

Press Trust of India
New Delhi

At least 320 Indians remain missing and around 400 others are stranded on the Chinese side following devastating flash floods along the Nepal-Tibet border and India is ready to extend all possible help to Kathmandu in its rescue efforts, the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) said on Friday.

MEA spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said 96 Indian nationals who were stranded on the Chinese side have safely crossed over to Nepal by the land route.

Twenty-one Indians arrived in New Delhi on Friday afternoon, a day after they reached Kathmandu from the flood-affected areas of Nepal, he said.

The Indian nationals from Tamil Nadu were received at the airport in the national capital by External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar.

RESCUE OPERATIONS

The death toll from Wednesday's flash floods in Nepal rose to 579 with more bodies recovered as search and rescue operations continued, according to latest details shared by Nepalese authorities. As many as 2,000 are still missing.

"As far as the number of people (Indians) whom we are not able to contact or who are missing, the figure at this point in time is 320," Jaiswal said.

"There are also around 100 persons of Indian origin who remained uncontactable. These are people of Indian origin who may have gone for Kailash Mansarovar Yatra, but they hold other nationalities," he said.



SAFE RETURN. External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar greeting a group of 21 tourists from Tamil Nadu, who returned from Nepal, at the New Delhi airport

Jaiswal said 400 Indians are stranded on the Chinese side but they are safe.

In a related development, Jaishankar held a high-level meeting with senior officials and reviewed the situation in Nepal with a focus on tracking the status of missing Indians.

Indian envoys to Kathmandu and Beijing also joined the meeting through virtual mode.

India dispatched a third tranche of 10 tonnes of relief supplies to flood-ravaged Nepal, alongside an 11-member team of doctors and paramedics, as well as a reconnaissance crew to assess tunnel rescue operations.

New Delhi had on Wednesday dispatched 10 tonnes of humanitarian assistance and disaster relief materials to the neighbouring country while another consignment of 37.5 tonnes of relief supplies was sent on Thursday.

"A third flight carrying 10 tonnes of humanitarian assistance has departed for

Kathmandu. The assistance includes portable generator sets, dignity kits, food packets and water purification tablets," Jaishankar said.

"An 11-member team of doctors, paramedics & Recce team for Tunnel rescue operations is also on-board. India continues to support Nepal's ongoing relief and rescue efforts," he said on social media.

Meanwhile, parts of Bihar faced the threat of a deluge as water levels in the Ganga, Gandak, Kosi and Burhi Gandak rivers showed a rising trend following the devastating flash floods.

EXCESS WATER

A senior official said that excess water brought in by the flash floods has caused the Gandak river to swell, forcing

authorities to open all 36 gates of a barrage over the river in Valmiki Nagar.

Around 1.02 lakh cusecs of water were released from the Gandak Barrage by 5 pm on Friday.

As many as 290 people from Maharashtra are stranded but confirmed safe in various parts of Nepal following the devastating flash floods while 60 tourists are still untraceable, a state government official said on Friday.

Further, 105 people from Maharashtra who were in Nepal at the time of the tragedy are on their way back to India, said the State Disaster Management Department official.

The European Union on Friday promised two million euros (\$2.3 mn) in aid for Nepal after devastating floods on the country's border with Tibet swept away entire villages, killing hundreds of people.

European Commission chief Ursula von der Leyen wrote on X that the "immediate humanitarian aid" would help "deliver life-saving assistance to families and communities hit hardest."

Flash flood disaster caused by glacier collapse: China

Press Trust of India
Beijing

China on Friday said the collapse of a high-altitude glacier in Nepal triggered the massive flash flood disaster that engulfed the Tibet-Nepal border.

Chinese Foreign Ministry spokesperson Lin Jian, said, "We noted that experts and official institutions of China and Nepal have made preliminary

assessment on the cause of the disaster. According to their analysis, the disaster has been triggered by a collapse of a high-altitude glacier in Nepal."

Scientists are also examining how a possible glacial collapse and ice-rock avalanche may have triggered the devastating flash floods, with preliminary assessments indicating that debris may have temporarily blocked Lhende river and created a landslide dam that subsequently gave way.

Initial speculation after the sudden surge near the Nepal-Tibet border crossing in Rasuwagadhi included a glacial lake outburst flood and an avalanche.

However, scientists analysing satellite imagery now believe a large mass of ice and rock may have fallen into Lhende river, temporarily blocking its flow and creating a landslide dam that subsequently gave way, The Kathmandu Post newspaper reported.

Praggnanandhaa beats Carauna to become first Indian to clinch Grand Chess Tour title

Press Trust of India
St Louis

Grandmaster R Praggnanandhaa became the first Indian to clinch the Grand Chess Tour (GCT) title, beating Fabiano Caruana of the US with a stunning comeback win in the grand finale.

Praggnanandhaa made a remarkable turnaround after trailing Caruana by six points at the start of the day at the Saint Louis Chess Club here. The Indian eventually prevailed 15-13 to win his maiden GCT title and pocket \$2,00,000 as the winning purse.

The title win also guaranteed Praggnanandhaa a spot in the next year's GCT along with Caruana and another American Wesley So, who



PRESTIGIOUS WIN. Grandmaster R Praggnanandhaa analyses his second round match against US's Fabiano Caruana in the Grand Chess Tour at the Saint Louis Chess Club on Friday

defeated Vincent Keymer of Germany 18-12 to take the third place. "Honestly, I didn't think I had many chances today," Praggnanandhaa told Chess.com.

"It's not every day that you can get one win from Fabi, but to get two, it was important in the rapid." The 21-

year-old started the day six points behind, but pulled another rabbit out of the hat and took a lead of two points after winning both the rapid games (four points to winner per game).

It was even-stevens in the subsequent four games of blitz, with Praggnanandhaa

and Caruana winning one each while the remaining two were drawn.

RAPID GAMES

The two-point lead at the end of the rapid games proved decisive for the Indian Grandmaster.

The first game of the blitz section was a drawn affair before Caruana won the second to level the scores at 12-12.

A determined Praggnanandhaa prevailed over his opponent in the third game to restore his two-point lead (14-12).

Had Caruana won the last blitz game, he would have forced two more games with the peculiar time control, followed by armageddon.

But, a draw was enough for Praggnanandhaa to win the match, and he did just that to seal a famous title.

Rising exports lift BYD profit for first time in 5 quarters

Bloomberg

BYD's profit rose for the first time in five quarters as surging exports and demand for some of its pricier models helped the world's largest electric-vehicle maker overcome a downturn in China.

Second-quarter net income climbed 30 per cent from a year earlier to 8.2 billion yuan (\$1.2 billion), according to figures derived from first-half earnings reported on Friday.

Earnings were slightly above the average analyst estimate compiled by Bloomberg, while revenue unexpectedly slipped about 3 per cent to 194.6 billion yuan.

The results bring a much-needed boost for BYD as intense competition with Xiaomi and Xpeng resulted in a year-long profit slump.

IndiGo announces investment in Sarvam, steps up AI focus

Aneesh Phadnis
Mumbai

IndiGo has announced investment in Sarvam AI as part of its broader strategy to use AI-led technologies for improved customer experience and innovation.

The investment was made through IndiGo Ventures, the airline's venture capital arm, that has previously invested in aerospace manufacturing and urban mobility start-ups.

IndiGo Venture's investment is a part of Sarvam's Series B funding in which the Bengaluru-based AI start-up raised around ₹698 crore from various investors. IndiGo Venture's committed around ₹30 crore, according to Sarvam's filing.

In a statement, IndiGo



said the investment builds on the existing relationship between the two companies.

WORKFORCE

"Artificial Intelligence is fast becoming a foundational capability for the aviation industry, reshaping customer experience, workforce productivity and operational decision-making. Our partnership with Sarvam gives IndiGo access to cutting-edge AI capabilities, built in India, and tailored to the needs of the market. By combining these technologies with our operational ex-

pertise and scale, we can accelerate innovation while maximising value for our customers, employees, and other stakeholders," Neetan Chopra, Chief Digital and Information Officer, IndiGo, said.

"IndiGo brings the domain depth and scale needed to identify where AI can create real value. Together, we can develop systems that are useful in production and build a stronger template for enterprise AI in India," said Pratyush Kumar, Co-founder, Sarvam AI.

IndiGo and Sarvam will continue to develop and evaluate applications across customer experience, employee productivity and airline operations, with the ability to expand successful use cases across the airline's network, the airline said.

Amid AI automation, firms look for polymath engineers

Sanjana B
Bengaluru

AI is reshaping what companies want from engineers, with deep technical expertise alone increasingly giving way to 'polymath' talent that can bridge technology, business and multiple disciplines, industry experts said.

For instance, in an earlier interaction with businessline, Rob Vatter, Executive President & Global Business Head — Aerospace & Defence at Quest Global, said the IT industry is betting on polymath engineers, or multi-skilled problem solvers, who blend technical depth with creative breadth, as AI reshapes traditional roles and demands a new breed of talent.

He described a polymath as someone who brings together multiple skills across different domains.

"Quest Global wants to develop that kind of engineer, especially due to the

widening demand-supply gap in talent. With AI taking over routine and repetitive tasks, engineers now need to operate at a higher level of productivity, making cross-domain capability essential," he said.

CHANGING ECONOMICS

Anuj Agrawal, Founder & CEO of Zyoin Group, attributed this rise in demand to three factors. First, business problems started crossing boundaries faster than organisations could restructure themselves. Any project today touches engineering, data, cloud, security, domain regulation, and commercial outcome.

The second is AI, which has enabled an individual to have the leverage that once required a team. This changes the economics of hiring permanently.

The third is scarcity, since few companies can afford a separate specialist for every capability that emerged in



the last 30 months. "A polymath is not someone who knows 10 subjects superficially, but someone with one or two areas of genuine depth, enough understanding of adjacent disciplines to connect them without an interpreter in the room, and the curiosity and AI fluency to learn whatever the problem demands next," Agrawal said.

DRIVING DEMAND

According to TeamLease Digital, even as AI has made highly specialised, repetitive technical work cheaper and easier to automate, more than 60 per cent of enter-

prise leaders say their biggest challenge is solving problems across different functions.

This is driving demand for hybrid roles such as forward deployed engineers (FDEs) and GTM engineers, who combine technical skills with business understanding and use AI tools to turn insights into strategy.

"Since ChatGPT's launch, structured, repetitive cognitive roles have fallen 10-15 per cent, while analytical, creative, and leadership-intensive work has grown 20-22 per cent. AI is absorbing task-based specialism, and the market is shifting toward T-shaped talent: professionals with core depth who can move fluidly across strategy, technology and execution," Neeti Sharma, CEO, TeamLease Digital, observed.

Alongside, job descriptions are evolving. Titles and tenure are giving way to skills and outcomes. AI fluency is now written into finance, HR, marketing, and op-

erations briefs, not just technical ones. "The qualifications section is shrinking while the ambiguity section grows; phrases like 'comfortable operating across functions' and 'able to own end-to-end' have become standard," he pointed out.

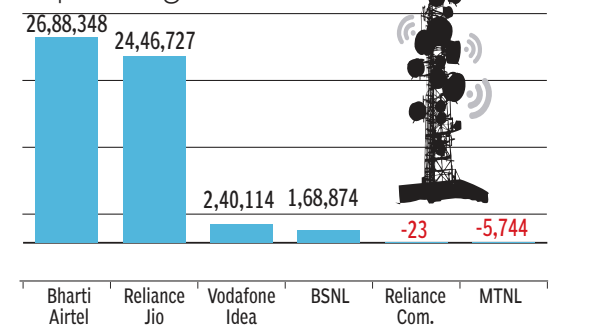
PRODUCT MANAGERS

Among the roles seeing the strongest demand for polymathic talent are engineering and product — particularly AI and platform engineering. Product managers are now expected to hold customer, technology, data, and unit economics simultaneously.

Others include solutions and transformation layer roles that sit where the customer problem meets domain, technology, implementation, and commercial outcome.

"Expect polymathic hiring to move from a differentiator to a baseline expectation within three to five years," Sharma added.

Expanding user base



"As per the information received from 1,562 operators for the month of July 2026, the total number of broadband subscribers increased from 1,087.50 million (108.75 crore) at the end of June 2026 to 1,094.48 million (109.44 crore) at the end of July 2026 with a monthly growth rate of 0.64 per cent," the Telecom Regulatory Authority of India said in its latest report.

For Bharti Airtel, net additions of 26.88 lakh mobile subscribers pushed its wireless subscriber base to 48.94 crore in July.

Reliance Jio added 24.46 lakh wireless users, taking its subscriber tally to 50.60 crore.

Vodafone Idea saw its mobile subscriber base rise to 19.90 crore, after gaining 2.40 lakh wireless subscribers.

Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	52WH	52WL	PE	BSE CI	Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	52WH	52WL	PE	BSE CI	Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	52WH	52WL	PE	BSE CI																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																											
Patanjali Dig	348.25	349.05	349.00	349.80	345.35	109941	1786.00	328.20	-	-	SHAKTI PUMPS	497.40	493.55	498.90	499.00	490.30	279.59	914.55	45.7	32	493.20	TELEMINIT FI	153.64	152.65	153.62	160.00	148.00	3794.83	160.00	110.41	-	-	EDEALIM-EBBETFO430	200.16	160.93	30.96	1646.18	1232.00																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																					
Patel Eng (1)	79.08	28.84	29.16	29.24	28.78	18071.72	40.58	22.77	7	28.33	Shakti Metafo	3.78	3.74	3.94	3.95	3.63102626.34	5.88	2.56	-	-	-	TVS Etc	443.05	447.00	444.00	444.00	435.25	27.15	74.05	33.70	-	33.55	EDEALIM-EBBETFO431	1432.87	1432.21	8.63	1469.00	1363.00																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																					
Patelk	12.08	12.20	12.20	12.20	12.15	154.23	12.20	12.20	-	-	SHALBA	154.23	154.23	154.23	154.23	154.23	154.23	154.23	154.23	154.23	154.23	TVS ETC-EBBETFO432	1310.48	1310.48	1310.48	1310.48	1310.48	1310.48	1310.48	1310.48	-	-	EDEALIM-EBBETFO433	1432.87	1432.21	8.63	1469.00	1363.00																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																					
Patelk	32.08	77.76	73.20	78.90	73.20	71.08	814.65	34.20	-	-	Shankara Bio	1242.10	1243.70	1242.00	1268.20	1240.10	181	138.00	63.00	-	-	TVS Motors (1)	440.89	430.40	440.89	442.05	415.21	265.44	374.80	32.28	50	430.00	EDEALIM-EGLD	157.15	158.10	46.62	184.95	10.15																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																					
PayTM	1679.00	1650.00	1685.00	1689.00	1641.00	1873.00	193.20	93.60	-	-	SHANKEESH Jear	86.69	91.73	89.66	92.56	87.25	4645.17	111.00	85.70	-	-	TVS S-Chain	130.79	131.56	131.09	133.66	130.30	88.65	146.50	90.32	-	-	Globe Bees (1)	130.05	130.85	2650.31	148.42	81.74	130.83	81.74	130.83	-	-	Globe Bees (2)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (3)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (4)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (5)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (6)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (7)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (8)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (9)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (10)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (11)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (12)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (13)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (14)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (15)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (16)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (17)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (18)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (19)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (20)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (21)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (22)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (23)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (24)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (25)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (26)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (27)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (28)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (29)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (30)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (31)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (32)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (33)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (34)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (35)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (36)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (37)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (38)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (39)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (40)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (41)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (42)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (43)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (44)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (45)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (46)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (47)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (48)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (49)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (50)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (51)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (52)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (53)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (54)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (55)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (56)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (57)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (58)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (59)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (60)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (61)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (62)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (63)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (64)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (65)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (66)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (67)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (68)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (69)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (70)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (71)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (72)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (73)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (74)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (75)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (76)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (77)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (78)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (79)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (80)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (81)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (82)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (83)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (84)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (85)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (86)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (87)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (88)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (89)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (90)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (91)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (92)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (93)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (94)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (95)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (96)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (97)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (98)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (99)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (100)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (101)	57.47	56.90	59.34	59.34	56.90	59.34	59.34	59.34	-	-	Globe Bees (102)	57.47	56.90	59

[illegible][illegible][illegible]

Servotax	81.12	80.97	81.15	81.69	80.40	130.91	143.00	57.51	-	-	TRIDENT [1]	24.38	24.32	24.40	24.48	24.27	2188.87	30.85	22.00	-	24.32	EDELMAN - EBANKIO	16.24	16.75	0.13	17.90	16.60	
Schweppa	399.95	402.10	399.00	414.00	398.75	130.55	143.45	209.11	-	-	Trigien Tech	60.09	62.85	59.45	64.82	59.27	1793.93	101.33	37.33	22	62.71	EDELMAN - EBANKNIPPY	58.27	15.83	2.68	69.39	50.05	
SH [5]	636.30	637.00	625.00	641.75	627.90	161.16	132.00	460.75	44	637.65	TRIVENTU [1]	582.22	583.80	582.80	592.37	579.37	314.60	195.34	24	584.00	EDELMAN - ECAPINSURE	20.24	20.24	25.88	20.50	20.50		
SG Mart L	810.25	789.30	809.00	819.45	785.30	739.64	60.60	313.10	-	-	TRIVENTU [1]	583.45	580.15	580.10	592.95	578.00	270.49	787.85	428.50	56	580.40	EDELMAN - EMULTIMQ	42.39	42.20	27.08	43.54	36.25	
SGF Service	687.45	685.85	690.80	690.80	682.05	107.78	72.75	323.00	-	-	Truealt BioEn	43.85	43.44	43.40	43.60	43.80	69.66	59.40	310.20	-	EDELMAN - ENEXT50	74.88	74.00	1.29	75.66	68.59		
SH Renus Sug [1]	23.40	24.14	23.63	24.79	23.50	95.88	33.50	21.06	-	24.08	TSF Invenit	40.24	40.27	40.59	40.95	40.93	40.40	70.150	33.70	-	EDELMAN - ENISFY	24.37	24.35	1.05	27.99	22.28		
Shadowfax [1]	23.63	24.36	23.86	24.79	23.50	95.84	26.85	96.55	-	-	TKT HEALTHCO	1080.20	1134.20	1087.90	1150.90	1081.00	75.11	1255.57	73.00	21	1135.55	EDELMAN - ENISFY	78.13	77.96	0.16	88.05	71.87	
SH [5]	3289.00	3327.00	3302.30	3310.00	3244.00	88.74	3615.20	1170.90	30	102.80	SHU PROTEGE	606.90	607.00	607.00	607.00	607.00	35	594.00	35	594.00	35	594.00	EDELMAN - ESUI	102.42	102.42	192.61	102.42	102.42
Shaily Eng	3289.00	3327.00	3302.30	3310.00	3244.00	88.74	3615.20	1170.90	30	102.80	TRIBE UNIV	287.00	280.00	280.00	288.50	283.50	12.84	341.90	2164.90	-	EDELMAN - BBTF0432	1342.23	1342.48	2.62	1378.00	1262.29		

The PE (price-earnings multiple) of each stock is based on the latest declared earnings.

The PE computation takes into account the per share earnings of each company for the latest 12 months.

BSE Stocks

[illegible]

CM YK S CH-CHE